

INSTITUTE OF EDUCATION  
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**PERCEPTIONS OF GLOBAL  
CITIZENSHIP AMONG  
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS  
AT DE MONTFORT  
UNIVERSITY, LEICESTER**

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## **Abstract**

The internationalisation of UK higher education has seen both an increase in the recruitment of international students and the growth of a rhetoric of globalisation. In order to inform policy and practice of development education and global learning, this dissertation explores international-students' perceptions of global citizenship and the ways in which their studies in the UK affect their attitudes towards global citizenship. In so doing it examines attributes of global citizenship such as intercultural competence and cosmopolitanism, awareness of global issues or dispositions towards civic participation. This qualitative based study incorporates in-depth interviews with six international students at De Montfort University, Leicester. It finds that perceptions and attitudes are dominated by Western representations. It argues, nonetheless, that cultural diversity on UK campuses is a tool which should be used to investigate the factors which condition our worldviews.

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## Chapter 1: Introduction

### 1.1. Aims of the Research

The purpose of this study is to provide insight into the perceptions of global citizenship amongst international students at UK universities, and to assess the effect of their study-abroad experience on these perceptions with the aim of informing policy and practice of global learning in higher education. The recruitment of increasing numbers of overseas students, encouraged by policies of internationalisation, is accompanied by a growing rhetoric of global citizenship (GC) in higher education. What GC means beyond the rhetoric formulated by policy-makers is open to debate (Bourn 2010); and it appears essential to take into consideration the voices of the students subjected to it. Therefore, by conducting a small-scale case study at De Montfort University, Leicester (DMU), this study set out to investigate the extent to which the way international students perceive the world and wish to engage with it may contribute to a shared meaning of GC in higher education (HE).

### 1.2. Context and Research Questions

Western countries and in particular the UK, have placed a strong focus on recruiting international students for their universities in recent years. In 2013 – 2014, non-UK students made up around 19% of the UK student-population (3 % more than the previous year), and almost 40% of all postgraduates (HESA 2015). The USA, UK, Australia and Canada combined, receive 40% of the students enrolled outside their country of citizenship worldwide (Universities UK 2014). This phenomenon, however, is part of a broader policy of internationalisation of HE, taking place against the backdrop of globalisation. Educational debates about globalisation and the transformations of the social world have seen the development of pedagogical approaches concerned with sustainable development and global social justice.

From these educational circles has emerged the term ‘global citizen’ as well as Global Citizenship Education (GCE) as a distinct educational practice (Bourn 2015). The term global citizen has nonetheless been incorporated into a variety of discourses on globalisation reflecting competing views and agendas. Moreover, the growth of the rhetoric of things global and the ideological struggle for meaning and collective representations in the public discourse contribute to confusion. Thus, in universities, students may be exposed to a galaxy of signifiers such as global employability, global competence, global graduates, global economy, global citizenship, and more.

The internationalisation of HE poses ethical questions. Does the education, in English, and to a Western worldview, of the élites of so-called developing countries not induce the development of these societies on Western terms? Who benefits from this? To what extent do policies of internationalisation of HE respond to the needs of people seeking education for an autonomous life? To what extent do they serve the economic and political interests of the West, spreading its economic influence and reinforcing its cultural hegemony?

These are amongst the questions that have constituted Development Education (DE). DE is a pedagogical approach which emerged in the 1960s and 1970s from educational traditions concerned with the links between societal issues and education including environment, peace, human rights or anti-racist education, and subsumed under the umbrella term of ‘global education’ (Bourn 2015). DE’s specificity was in promoting understanding of development issues in the context of de-colonisation and asymmetrical relations between the “North” and the “South”. However, with the growing integration of the world economies, globalisation has become the paradigm for understanding social injustice — DE is now also referred to as development education and global learning. It is characterised by a global outlook and a concern for sustainable development, democracy, intercultural understanding and

global social justice. Influenced by critical theory and the critical pedagogy of Paolo Freire or Henry Giroux (Bourn 2015), it is a radical approach to education aimed at increasing understanding of the world we live in and at producing subjectivities that will engage critically and actively with it, to make it more just.

But who is to decide what is just? DE questions the model of development based on Western modernity and imposed upon the countries of the 'South' through economic globalisation and development policies, and points to increased social inequalities and disenfranchisement. The question of 'voice' is key to an ethical form of the development of societies. This involves empowering marginalised voices and bringing non-Western perspectives to our understanding of development. Accordingly, the representations of the world projected by Western universities must be questioned insofar as they are imposed on an increasing number of students coming from countries subjected to Western-led globalisation. Who is legitimate in defining the best way to respond to global issues? Who is legitimate in defining the identity of the global citizen?

The purpose of this research is to give a voice to international students, in order to understand how they perceive globalisation, how they experience their sense of place in the world and the way they want to engage with it. The ambition of this study is to explore the possibility of international students' representations contributing to an ethical construction of the meaning of GC in HE. Despite the high profile the term has gained over recent years and the pervasiveness of discourses on globalisation in HE, issues relating to GC in HE remain under-researched. As an illustration, the 2015 conference of the Society for Research into Higher Education only features 5 out of 294 research papers addressing this topic (SRHE 2015).



This dissertation aims at providing policy-makers and practitioners with an understanding of international-students' perceptions of GC, of their expectations about their studies in the UK, and insight into the factors that contribute to learning about GC. The research is based on a constructivist approach and the analysis of qualitative data. Six in-depth interviews were conducted with under- and post-graduate students from Libya, Saudi Arabia, China and Brazil, at DMU, between April and July 2015. Two main research questions structure the study:

- What are international-students' perceptions of global citizenship?
- To what extent has studying at DMU fostered global citizenship?

The small number of participants consulted in this study as well as the restricted array of countries represented limit the generalisation of the results. Nonetheless, the analysis reveals patterns and attitudes which may shed some light on the study-abroad experience of many students in a number of comparable institutions. I argue that while international students tend to adhere to a Western worldview and do not significantly contribute counter-hegemonic perspectives to the meaning construction of GC, their presence on British campuses is nonetheless an underestimated source of learning about the ways we are conditioned to think.

### **1.3. Personal Rationale**

My personal rationale for investigating these issues stems from my involvement in international education. As I taught in Asia for two years, I became concerned about the spread of a hegemonic worldview at the expense of local cultures, through the education of the privileged sections of local populations in Anglo-American 'international' schools. I also became concerned about my complicit participation. Later, teaching English for Academic Purposes (EAP) in UK universities seemed somewhat less imperialistic — international students

‘choose’ to study abroad and to obtain an English degree. However, some insight into students’ motivations questioned this reassuring assumption of self-determination. The economic regime imposed on the world leaves people with little choice but to play by Western rules. My interest in DE was sustained by approaches to social sciences which problematize the domination of Western epistemology, and posit that the challenges posed to humanity — global social inequality, destruction of the environment — can only be tackled if the West renounces its claims to universalism.

Thus, the choice for the focus of this research was guided by academic interest and professional concern. The themes that run through this dissertation (the dialectical relation between universalism and particularism in a world where increasingly, differences must cohabit; the influence of social and cultural change on our sense of identity and place in the world; the role of education and its relation to social change) are amongst key issues in contemporary social sciences, and my engagement with these questions will form the basis for future academic development.

I hope that this research will contribute to the enhancement of teaching and learning at DMU by providing internationalisation policies with insight into the importance of intercultural competence in increasingly diverse classrooms and lecture theatres, and into the pedagogical value of a global outlook on contemporary issues. As an EAP tutor, I am at a key outpost of the internationalising university. We are the first Western teachers thousands of students meet, we have the privilege of introducing them to an intimidating foreign educational system, and the responsibility for initiating a positive relationship to learning in this new cultural environment.

#### **1.4. Structure of the Dissertation**

This dissertation is structured as follows. Chapter two is a literature review which explores the key concepts informing the debates about GC, presents the educational principles and purposes of GCE, and outlines the main issues pertaining to its implementation in the context of internationalisation of HE. These concepts are then drawn together into the theoretical framework which is used to analyse the research data. Chapter three describes the methodological aspects of the study and the context in which it was conducted. Chapter four presents and discusses the findings relative to both research questions in reference to the theoretical framework described in chapter two. Finally, the concluding chapter provides a overall answer to the research questions, reflects on the rationale for the study and proposes a number of recommendations for the education of global citizens in HE.

## **Chapter 2: Literature Review**

This study is concerned with the extent to which international students may become global citizens in the context of their studies in UK universities. This chapter builds on the literature I reviewed to explore the meanings of the concept of GC and their implications for the context of internationalisation of HE. The chapter comprises four sections. Firstly, I explore the meaning of GC as a term within social and political sciences, and within educational contexts. Secondly, I examine some of the impacts of globalisation on HE and DE propositions for an ethical internationalisation. Thirdly, I review in more detail, aspects of learning in the cultural contexts created by internationalisation. These include intercultural competence, identity and language. Finally, as I conclude this chapter, I present the conceptual framework which will guide the analysis of the research data and the discussion of the findings.

### **2.1. Global Citizenship**

#### **2.1.1. Global Citizenship or Cosmopolitanism?**

The idea of GC dates back to Ancient Greek Stoic and Cynic philosophers, for whom cosmopolitan literally meant ‘citizen of the universe’. A cosmopolitan was someone who was open to other cultures and ideas, and not limited to the traditions of his or her community (Rizvi 2005). The idea that human beings belong to a more fundamental community transcending particular cities or nations re-emerged in the Enlightenment and again in the twentieth century (Dower 2003). For Kant, our belonging to this transnational human community compels us to a political and ethical aspiration that involves universal rights and respect for diversity (Todd 2007). In the context of an increasingly economically and politically integrated world the idea of GC and cosmopolitanism have become all the more pertinent and

debated within political sciences, social sciences and education. These debates are marked by complexity as GC is a term towards which converge a number of distinct and sometimes competing discourses involving different political agendas, and views on both citizenship and globalisation. Thus, Moraes (2014) calls it a ‘floating signifier’ — a term that may stand for many or even any referent; that ‘may mean whatever their interpreters want them to mean’ (Chandler 2007: 78).

Authors have devised typologies that map out the ideologies and agendas underlying various understandings of GC. Schattle (2008) distinguishes four prominent ideologies that inform the meaning of the term in Anglo-Saxon public discourse. Moral cosmopolitanism, often presented as an extension of liberalism’s universal principles of human rights; liberal multiculturalism, encompassing the moral imperative of mutual respect across cultures and the duty to protect minority cultures within diverse societies; neoliberalism, the dominant economic ideology driving the current phase of globalisation; and environmentalism, an ideology that challenges common assumptions regarding economic development in relation to its impact on the environment. Schattle (2008) notes that with the exception of environmentalism, these ideologies can be understood as versions of liberalism, characterised by a fundamental emphasis on the individual’s rights and free will. Moreover, the author maintains that while GC is often framed within discourses of moral cosmopolitanism and liberal multiculturalism, all four ideological realms may intersect and co-exist within the same discourse. Importantly, Schattle (2008) rejects the idea of the emergence of globalism, as a new ideology. Instead, the various understandings of the term illustrate how familiar ideologies are adapting to an increasing public awareness of global interdependence.

Other typologies draw a line between hegemonic and counter-hegemonic conceptions of GC. Tully (2014) distinguishes ‘civil’ from ‘civic’ citizenship. The former is imposed by nation-states and defines the legal frame for the exercise of national citizenship while the latter is based upon the social practices whereby active citizens call legal structures to ‘negotiation’. Taking a postcolonial stance, Tully argues that the civil model institutionalised in Europe and grounded in liberalism, was spread across the world as a colonial project disguised in the apparatus of free trade, human rights and self legitimising universalism. He calls this globalised, top-down form of citizenship ‘cosmopolitan citizenship’, and ‘glocal citizenship’ the global, counter-hegemonic grassroots approach to citizenship which finds its most telling manifestation in the World Social Forum. Similarly, Oxley and Morris (2013) identify two broad categories. A ‘cosmopolitan based’ GC rooted into classical Greek philosophy and Enlightenment liberalism, contested for its universalistic perspective and associated by some with Euro-centric imperialism; and a counter-hegemonic model, ‘advocacy based’. Oxley and Morris’ framework provides a detailed account of the complex lines of tension within various perspectives. Thus, the cosmopolitan model is divided into political, moral, economic and cultural cosmopolitanism, and the advocacy based model into social, critical, environmental and spiritual GC.

These frameworks categorise the ways in which GC is understood within different philosophical and political traditions. Contentious issues regarding diversity and universalism, imperialism and emancipation fuel the debates.

Influential academics have proposed universalist conceptions of GC based on Greek classicism, Kantian universalism and Human Rights. Nussbaum (2011) argues for the existence of a set of universal norms and values attached to the conditions that make possible the development of human lives in compliance with the principle of equal dignity. For the Stoics,

Nussbaum writes, we should not give up our local affiliation but ‘think of ourselves as surrounded by a series of concentric circles’ comprising the self, family, neighbours, city-dwellers, countrymen; and ‘draw the circles somewhat towards the center’; we need ‘to give up our special affections and identifications’ and ‘work to make all human beings part of our community of dialogue and concern’ (Nussbaum 1997: 60). This concern for moral inclusion resonates with Opatow’s (1990) description of moral exclusion as the source of injustice and discrimination: ‘Moral exclusion occurs when individuals or groups are perceived as outside the boundary in which moral values, rules, and considerations of fairness apply’. In the UK, Dower has been one of the most influential academic figures in promoting GC (Bourn 2010). His conception of GC relies on the commitment to a ‘global ethic’ and on personal responsibility. For Dower (2003), people have moral duties that extend to all mankind, including a duty of assistance towards those afflicted with poverty; we are members of one global community and should strive towards a world where these values are realised through institutions and legal frameworks. Dower indeed argues that the UN is the embodiment of the cosmopolitan moral of Human Rights.

Such views are severely criticised by authors inspired by postcolonialism and anti-imperialism. They insist that discourses of moral obligation maintain the disenfranchised as objects of the benevolence of the North, thereby reaffirming a sentiment of moral superiority and the myth of the ‘white man’s burden’ of the European colonial project (Andreotti 2011; Jefferess 2012). Classical approaches are also guilty of not addressing the causes of inequality. Jefferess (2012) contends that Dower’s concept of GC is uncritically grounded in Western notions of the state and of agency as free will, and ahistorical in that it does not engage with the world-system structures of inequality inherited from colonisation. Nussbaum advances an ‘imperialist’ agenda, for Arneil (2007) who rejects liberal humanist values presented as

universal. Santos (2002) also contests the universalist character of Human Rights in its Western formulation and argues for a cross-cultural re-conception. Like Tully, he sees the World Social Forum as the realisation of emancipatory social practices and an arena for the emergence of a new form of knowledge on the bases of which a counter-hegemonic GC can rise. A new global citizenry, rooted in the defence of social rights and in the awareness of ‘shared fate’ of all humanity, is also called for to resist the ‘Liberal Empire’ — the US global political project based on military and economic hegemony (Arneil 2007).

The question of GC legitimately raises questions regarding the relevance of a global government. As citizenship is a concept historically linked to the modern nation-state (Tully 2014) its validity seems to rely on the existence of an authority that guarantees rights and participation. A world government securing Human Rights, according to Dower (2003: 120), only reflects the view of those with a ‘very strong aspirational aspect to their understanding of global citizenship’; the idea of global citizenship does not commit to such a form of apparatus. Dower (1998) nonetheless suggests that state sovereignty be challenged by an international ethical framework. For others, institutionalising global moral norms is not desirable. For Parekh (2003: 12, *italics in original*) ‘the cosmos is not yet a *polis*, and we should not even try to make it one by creating a world state’ that would inevitably be ‘remote, bureaucratic, oppressive, and culturally bland’. Instead he calls for a ‘globally oriented citizen’ with a ‘valued home’ from which to reach out and form alliances with others having homes of their own. Similarly, Appiah (1997: 618) defends the idea of a ‘cosmopolitan patriot’, ‘a rooted cosmopolitan’ whose moral responsibility extends internationally. A legal definition of GC appears inappropriate, instead, GC is defined in terms of attitudes, as a state of mind.



### 2.1.2. Global Citizenship Education

Global Citizenship Education (GCE) proposes a notion of GC committed to values of active civic participation, global social justice and sustainable development. GCE emerged in the 1990s as a distinctive pedagogical approach under the combined influence of development education and environment education (Bourn 2015). Civic participation involves an understanding of, and a preparation to, the world's rapid changes. Understanding how the global and the local co-exist in a systemic relation that affects the economic, social and cultural aspects of people's lives has become critical in order to lead a life of dignity and to engage in civic action in an era characterised by increased interconnectedness, integration and diversity, technical complexity, and uncertainty. Bourn (2008: 5) defines a category of 'global skills' that can be read as the global citizen's skills. They include the ability to communicate and cooperate with people with different social and cultural backgrounds, openness to a range of 'perspectives from around the world', the ability to solve problems, understand the impact of globalisation on our lives and play an active role in society.

Oxfam has significantly contributed to a definition of the values-base for GCE (Bourn 2010). The global-citizen attributes that the NGO proposes emphasise cognitive skills (e.g. the awareness of how the world functions as a system) but perhaps most notably values and attitudes — a global citizen is sensitive to diversity, justice and global poverty and determined to take action towards bettering the world (Oxfam 2006). Though the emphasis placed on individual action and a presumed enlightenment about the world is critiqued by Schattle (2008) for its excessively liberal stance, Oxfam's framework is regarded by some as constituting the attributes of global-citizen identity (Chen 2011). Pike (2008), on the other hand, proposes moral principles for GCE that distance themselves from liberal humanism. He too highlights the necessity to understand global interdependence and structures of injustice in order to exercise participative citizenship, as well as cognitive skills suited to the complexity

and problems of our time. However, unlike Oxfam, Pike ascribes rights to the planet, places human life on the same plane as other forms of life by suggesting our loyalty expand to all living things, and names imperialism as a threat to justice.

Common to educationalists from various backgrounds is the conviction that GCE must involve political literacy. Osler and Kerry (2002), who propose a formulation of GC derived from classical cosmopolitanism supported by a commitment to Human Rights and liberal multiculturalism, call for ‘cosmopolitan democracy’. The development of NGO initiatives such as Oxfam or Greenpeace that challenge the power of the WTO or the IMF, heralds its emergence. It is a necessity if globalisation is to become a more democratic process. The authors maintain that young people are willing to address issues of global inequality, but lack of knowledge and the skills to explore the political dimension of these problems limits their action to charity. Indeed, while charity initiatives such as ‘Make Poverty History’ have encouraged a form of GC committed to global justice among young people (Bourn 2011), they have failed to engage with the causes of inequalities. Authors within postcolonial circles contend that the form of GC pushed by these initiatives is not only uncritical, but founded on a subject position shaped by discourses on development that pursue the Western colonial project. By concealing the relation between colonisation and globalisation these discourses create global citizens unable to act politically (Biccum 2010; Andreotti 2011). Hence Andreotti proposes a move towards *critical* literacy.

A radical trend of GCE, informed by postcolonial studies and poststructuralism, proposes a form of political literacy which addresses the articulation of power with language, discourse and knowledge. Andreotti (2011) contends that the projection of the values and interests of the West as universal naturalises the myth of Western supremacy. This naturalisation is made possible by a discourse of modernisation where colonisation is ‘ignored or placed securely in

the past' (Andreotti 2006: 44) and where poverty is constructed as lack of resources and education 'rather than a lack of control over the production of resources' (Biccum 2005: 1017), thus placing the 'responsibility of poverty upon the poor themselves' (Andreotti 2006: 45). The naturalisation of Western cultural constructs is also made possible by what Spivak (in Andreotti 2011) calls 'epistemic violence', which changes the indigenous' perceptions of self and reality and makes them adhere to the values of the colonisers. This ideology is then reproduced by the élites who benefit from these structures of power both in the West and in the South. Critical literacy involves understanding the historic and cultural origin of our assumptions, their contingency and their implications. Global citizens need to engage with their own perspective as well as with others', for knowledge, which is a historical and cultural construction, is always incomplete — we always lack the knowledge constructed in other cultural contexts. Andreotti's critical GCE does not provide content knowledge about the world, rather it creates spaces to engage with other worldviews.

This section has outlined different meanings of the term GC within various political and philosophical discourses. The integration of diverse societies into one, social, economic and cultural, global society, is of such political significance that defining the identity of the citizen of this society is an ideological struggle. A global citizen could be a successful professional striving in the global economy, an activist engaged in environmental protection, a liberal humanist committed to Human Rights, an anti-imperialist militant fighting for social rights, and more. While an educational movement made up of diverse voices, DE advocates for a global citizen who is aware and critical of global issues and of the relations of power that structure society, and who is willing to take action to change the world on the basis of values for social justice. GC is but one dimension of identity, it does not rule out the others; it is the recognition of our interconnectedness and interdependency.

The internationalised university is a space where tomorrow's society is being designed. It is also, therefore, a space where these ideologies are in conflict. The following section describes the educational context in which international students are engaged, and outlines some of the issues pertaining to GC.

## **2.2. Internationalisation**

Although universities have historically always had an international dimension, the term 'internationalisation of higher education' has emerged in the last 25 years (de Wit and Hunter forthcoming). In the 20<sup>th</sup> century, international HE was enacted by government-funded programmes which aimed at promoting peace and international understanding through student mobility and international degree recognition. However, since the 1990s, there has been a move from a political to an economic rationale influenced by the currently dominant view of a knowledge-based economy that has placed competitiveness at the heart of internationalisation (de Wit and Hunter forthcoming). Preparing graduates for the global labour market, attracting global talent and recruiting international students for the 'multi-million-dollar business' they represent (Knight 2013: 87) have become the 'pillars of internationalisation' (de Wit and Hunter forthcoming). Internationalisation includes two increasingly entwined dimensions: internationalisation 'at home' and 'abroad' (Knight 2008: 22). While the former may refer to foreign student recruitment or a focus on intercultural skills, the latter refers to the activities universities develop abroad (offshore campuses, partnerships with foreign universities), and to the mobility of teaching staff. Recognising the complexity of a multi-faceted phenomenon, Knight (2008: 21) proposes a working definition of internationalisation that purposefully leaves aside the many different agendas, purposes and outcomes of internationalisation while trying to encompass the various ways it is actually enacted: 'Internationalization at the national/sector/institutional levels is the process of integrating an international, intercultural or global dimension into the purpose, functions or delivery of higher education

at the institutional and national levels'. Theorising internationalisation requires distinguishing it from globalisation, the backdrop against which it is taking place. While Bourn (2011) sees internationalisation as the response of HE to the challenges of globalisation, Killick (2015) suggests it should also be seen as a driver of globalisation. However, Scott (in de Wit 2010: 8) suggests the distinction 'cannot be regarded as categorical. They overlap, and are intertwined, in all kinds of ways.'

As the term 'global dimension' has become a discursive marker of the presence of themes such as GC or environment education (EE) in the English curriculum for primary and secondary education (Bourn 2015), the term 'global perspectives' has become its equivalent in HE (Lunn 2008). Lunn (2008: 234) indicates that the term is used as a 'discursive coalition' reflecting the interpretations of the various actors who use the term in 'their own professional and cultural context'. Thus different stakeholders promote global perspectives. The government wants the UK to thrive in the competitive global marketplace for HE provision and 'produce graduates who can contribute to the economic, political, social, and cultural life of the nation'; employers want graduates who can work in international and multicultural contexts; institutions want international reputation; students want their experience in HE to be a 'springboard for living, travelling, and working around the world' (Lunn 2008: 234). However, Shiel (2013) uses the term to coalesce the agendas of DE and EE, and to avoid the unhelpful disputes around 'labels' applied to capture similar concerns, i.e. education for sustainable development v. education for sustainability. She builds on Oxfam's framework for GC and extends it to a HE setting: global perspectives are a holistic approach to achieve a paradigm shift in education and serve an agenda of social justice and environmental sustainability, and to 'prepare graduates for the global context, as global citizens' (Shiel 2013: 39).

The development of global perspectives involves challenging dominant ideologies rooted in economic rationalism. Bourn (2011) notes that the responses of universities to globalisation throughout the world have mostly been economic and have tended to reinforce the dominant neoliberal ideology about the purposes of HE; he argues for a recognition of the impact of globalisation as reaching beyond the purely economic dimension and of the need to address the social, cultural and environmental challenges globalisation poses. Bourn (2011: 568) contends that internationalisation has nonetheless triggered debates that do challenge these ideologies: increasingly diverse student populations and the need to address intercultural dialogue have raised questions not only about the content of the curricula, but about how students learn and about methodologies. Killick (2015: 15) however, does not see this move as significant enough. He emphasises that the major driver of internationalisation has been market fundamentalism and that a reorientation of educational policy is not radical enough an approach to counter the neoliberal offensive on one of its key targets: the ‘soul’ of the university.

The market logic driving internationalisation reinforces neoliberal conceptions of cosmopolitanism by encouraging mobility and competition. The dominant view on GC in UK HE is influenced by an instrumental, and inadequate, cosmopolitan model associated to an assumption that places international mobility at its heart (Caruana 2014), notwithstanding many studies showing that international mobility or language learning do not necessarily enhance intercultural competence (Hunter 2008; Kinginger 2011; Trahar 2011a; Pashby 2012; Caruana 2014). Allport for example (In Caruana 2014: 90), maintains that ‘prejudice is only reduced by sustained intercultural contact that reaches below the surface and involves groups of people who enjoy equal status in the pursuit of common goals’. Caruana (2014: 102) insists that the increasing diversity of the student body offers an underestimated potential for the re-conceptualisation of GC ‘as a concept embracing diversity, belonging, community and

solidarity'. International competition for employability sets the context in which cosmopolitan identities are produced (Rizvi 2005). From his studies in Australian HE, Rizvi (2005) finds that a significant number of international students come from privileged classes and have already attended elite international schools in their countries (India, China). Rizvi (2005: 91) argues that these students engage with their studies abroad with a 'strategic cosmopolitanism imagery already in mind' and this view of the world is reinforced by the fact that the cultural interaction encouraged by international education 'occurs within a logic of consumption, under the new global economic conditions'. Chen's (2011) study with Chinese students in the UK similarly shows that while students develop their awareness of diversity to an extent, their understanding of GC remains strongly affiliated to national values and associated to instrumental strategies for success in the global economy.

Propositions for a counter-hegemonic perspective on internationalisation have put forward the need for a critique of pedagogical practices and for a transformation of the curricula. Education for GC in HE requires pedagogic principles appropriate to the education of graduates who will be critical of social norms and of the ideologies structuring societies (Bourn 2011). Such principles can be found in the educational theories of Freire and Giroux, which challenge the existing structures of society and a mode of teaching and learning that reinforces and conforms to them, and in Andreotti's critical GCE, which challenges Western-dominated assumptions on development and globalisation (Bourn 2011). The necessity for university to remain a place where ideologies can be critiqued is also strongly emphasised by Killick (2015: 15) who deplores the 'commodification' which does not encourage a 'sceptical bent', as it would 'sit uncomfortably in objectives for employable students'.

Furthermore, curricula must prepare for the new social and professional conditions graduates will face as well as the cultural diversity of the student body. Initiatives for the implementation of global perspectives within some university programmes have introduced elements of cultural awareness, critical appreciation of development processes or understanding of interdependent global systems (McKenzie et al. 2003), although Bourn and Blum (2013) note that curriculum change designed to address the challenges of globalisation is generally neglected. Change also concerns more culturally-sensitive pedagogical approaches. Trahar (2011a; 2011b) questions Western assumptions about the nature and the acquisition of knowledge and stresses that teaching practices are culturally situated and learning always culturally mediated. Diversified practices would provide richer learning experiences for both international and home students to build a more culturally aware sense of citizenship.

Finally, the university must acknowledge the profound effects of globalisation on social and cultural processes which condition the ways people construct their identities. Identities have traditionally been produced within spaces that are losing their salience with globalisation. Killick (2011; 2015) argues that nation-states, but also family, work and traditions no longer provide the sense of home we used to rely upon and that the kind of identity that will most readily make students find their way into the globalising world is a key question for HE. Killick's (2015) concept of 'global self' is at the heart of his proposal for university education. It comprises two notions: 'self in the world' and 'act in the world'. While the latter refers to a set of capabilities to enact one's life, the former refers to one's perception of self, constructed within an ethical relation with the other across cultures. Killick (2015: 29) proposes the term 'global self', because the term 'global citizen', he argues, is 'highly contested and confused', 'tied with disputes about universal "rights" and cultural relativism', and 'depends upon somewhat utopian forms of global governance'. It could be argued however, that the term citizenship assumes a more politically-oriented identity. Bourn's (2010) notion of global



citizen identity more explicitly ‘relates to being informed social activists’. Bourn recognises the existence among the student population of a will to engage with global social injustice or environmental issues, and harnesses the need for students to make sense of a rapidly changing world to the strengthening of a set of values for global justice.

In this section I have outlined the issues relating to internationalisation, defined as the strategies adopted by the university to respond to globalisation but also as the processes by which the university is an agent of globalisation. Neoliberal ideological hegemony determines to a large extent the ethos of the university and the identity of the citizens it produces. The Development Education counter-project proposes to form graduates who are critical of the ideologies that shape the social world, understand how globalisation affects their lives at the local level, are cognitively equipped to tackle the challenges posed by increased complexity and uncertainty, and ethically prepared to take action on the basis of values for social justice.

### **2.3. Identity and Global Citizenship**

Questions of intercultural competence and identity appear as recurrent themes in GCE. This section outlines key issues pertaining to the notion of identity and how identities are being challenged by rapid social change. It stresses the relevance of intercultural competence and of the English language to a global citizen identity emerging from the internationalised university.

#### **2.3.1. Identities and Globalisation**

For social theorists, the transformations of social and cultural life in the contemporary world put identity under stress. Bauman (2000; 2004) argues that the historic resources for identity-construction are being challenged. The decline of the welfare state undermines national iden-

tity while insecurity and flexibility in employment and personal relationships unsettle traditional sites for identification. For Giddens (2002), it is the erosion of tradition and custom, religion and family, which fundamentally changes our sense of self. Appadurai (1996) provides a framework to appreciate the significance of the cultural hybridisation which transforms our relations to the world. The increasing mobility of people, technology, capital, means of communication and ideologies create the new conditions under which people negotiate new affiliations, lifestyles and ways of belonging (Block 2009; Higgins 2011; Killick 2015). The idea dominates that identity is no longer a secure essence, but rather a social construction subjected to negotiation, change, uncertainty and imagination.

There is no space here to give an exhaustive account of the various ways in which identity has been conceptualised in psychology and social sciences. However, an approach that questions modernist essentialism is of interest in order to consider how new identities emerge as new social contexts appear.

The prominent approach to the concept of identity in the social sciences has been influenced over the last decades by poststructuralism (Block 2009; Higgins 2011). Traditionally, social research has privileged either biology (skin colour, biological sex, etc.) or social structures (social class, family, etc.) as determinants of identity (Block 2009). These approaches assume that identity is determined by conditions that pre-exist individuals and on the other hand that 'groups' can be clearly defined. The poststructuralist approach to identity has emerged as a response to these two forms of essentialism and is mainly characterised by the centrality of language and discourse, and focuses on 'the ways in which individuals are constituted as subjects' (Smart in Block 2009: 15). A narrow meaning of the term discourse is concerned with the mechanics of language, however, Foucault (1971) offers a broader understanding encompassing the processes of knowledge production and social practices that construct

social reality and subjects. Gee (2008: 3) broadens the meaning even further and proposes ‘Discourse’ as an ‘identity kit’ to enact social identities: ‘Discourses are ways of behaving, interacting, valuing, thinking, believing, speaking...that are accepted as instantiations of particular identities ... “ways of being in the world”’. Discourses, here, constitute resources for individuals to adopt subject positions. Do postmodern social sciences, then, do away with identity as a deeper, continual sense of self? Gee (2008) uses the term identity to refer specifically to ‘socially situated identity’ enacted within discourses, and demonstrates scepticism towards the actuality of a fixed, ‘core identity’. Lemke (2007: 24), commenting on Butler’s (1993) seminal work about gender identity, argues that individuals ‘play the role’, ‘perform [the] part’ that fits a ‘scenario’. The language of drama might suggest that enacting these social identities is a voluntary action underlain by an agent, by an ‘I’ from which it proceeds. Butler (1993: 95) however, is adamant that her concept is to do with performativity, not ‘theatrical self-presentation’, and that identity is a ‘doing’ without there being a ‘doer’ behind the ‘deed’ (Butler 1993: 33). Butler challenges the existence of an ‘I’ that has not been subjected to discourse.

The way we understand identity is key to understanding and responding to rapid social and cultural change. The university is a space for new social and cultural practices, increasingly transnational and hybrid, and for new possibilities for identification. The extent to which the cosmopolitan nature of these spaces nurture a global citizen identity relies heavily on intercultural competence.

### **2.3.2. Global Citizen Identity?**

#### *Intercultural competence*

Cultural awareness and intercultural competence, the ability to see the world through cultural-others’ eyes, are key elements of global citizen identity. These aspects have been the

focus of educationalists involved in studying-abroad programmes and international education. In her study with ‘top intercultural experts’ Deardorff (2008) finds that the ability to understand cultural-others’ worldview is the only factor unanimously identified as essential while elements such as language proficiency or cultural knowledge are deemed necessary but not sufficient. She also notes that cognitive flexibility, critical thinking and reflexivity stand out as the means by which one can shift one’s frame of reference, become aware of one’s own cultural bias, relativize others’, and adapt one’s behaviour. Thus, mindfulness and awareness of how our own culture shapes our representations and attitudes appear more determining than knowledge about the culture we seek to adapt to, or more than mastery of a target language.

Approaches that focus on reflexivity such as transformative or experiential learning are seen as most appropriate to intercultural competence acquisition (Savicki 2008; Hunter 2008; Deardorff 2008; Killick 2015). Authors highlight that intercultural learning engages the learner affectively, impacts on attitudes, values and identity more deeply than does the mere acquisition of knowledge. Self-examination is therefore critical. Savicki (2008: 76) notes that learning is not necessarily a result of experience and that ‘excessive repetition of unexamined experiences can lock in prejudices and ethnocentric views’. Prejudices are likely to be reinforced when we fail to engage with the challenges the confrontation of worldviews presents. Killick (2015) draws on Husserl’s and Heidegger’s phenomenology as well as on the social theories of Bourdieu and Foucault to describe the irreducible subjectivity of our experience of the world, the construction of our sense of self as a product of this experience, and the importance of the unconscious, unexamined socio-historic determinants that shape it. Reflexivity and critical thinking are seen by the author as key skills for the development of intercultural capability. Reflexivity is also a critical aspect of Andreotti’s (2011) propositions for GCE, where learning relies on the conscientisation of the historical and social conditions

that shape one's subjectivity in order to 'read the world through other eyes'. This type of learning is akin to the deep and structural shift characterising 'meaning perspective' transformation in Mezirow's (1994) model of transformative learning, which Illeris (2014) suggests is a transformation of 'identity'.

### *The role of English*

English, often as an additional language, is the language used in these educational contexts where cosmopolitan practices develop. Its status and role are nonetheless disputed. The ways in which various cultural groups relate to English and are represented in it are at issue. The subject positions constructed in the discourses that have become linked to English may not be appropriate for enacting GC identity.

English is the language of economic power and its domination reinforces structures of inequality. English has become the language of technology, of the Knowledge Economy and of neoliberal globalisation (Singh, Kell and Pandian 2002). Its spread through international education and globalisation reproduces unequal power-relations in that the cultural capital and social values of privileged Anglo-American classes are imposed globally, placing those who do not speak the class-based model of standardised English at a political and economic disadvantage (Singh et al. 2002; Guilherme 2007; O'Regan 2014). An approach of English as a universal means of communication, falsely 'detached from the agenda of the powerful' (Phillipson 2009: 338), is unsuitable. Although research from linguists committed to this approach — English as a lingua Franca (ELF) — has made significant contribution to our understanding of how English could be taught for intercultural communication (Cogo 2011), such an uncritical approach actually conceals power relations, argues O'Regan (2014: 534) who criticises the ELF 'movement' for being 'ideologically conservative'. However, Guilherme (2007:

74), who notes that English ‘is the language of imperialism, consumerism, marketing, Hollywood, multinationals, war and oppression’ stresses that it is also that of ‘opportunity, science, social movements, peace processes, human rights and intercultural exchanges’. She recognises the potential of English to become a language for GC, if it is taught within a postcolonial framework.

To become the common language for a counter-hegemonic global social force English must empower rather than subjugate the learner and the society to which she belongs (Guilherme 2007). English, as the language of the British Empire, is fraught with racist and sexist constructions (Pennycook 1998; Singh et al. 2002), and those who learn it discover they have already been defined within the colonial discourses English has become linked with. For Guilherme (2007) English education must repudiate the ethnocentric ideology of the traditional model associating English with a specific Anglo-Saxon culture. Appropriating English (Singh et al. 2002), whereby learners who have been ‘othered’ by it can negotiate meanings, have their perspective accounted for and can deconstruct discourses in which they are defined, is a *sine qua non* if English is to become a global citizen language.

## 2.4. Conclusion and Theoretical Framework

In this literature review I have emphasised that GC is a term that belongs to different political discourses promoting different worldviews and agendas. I have also outlined the meaning of the term for DE, an educational approach concerned with political change and global social justice. In the second section I have shown the pertinence of such a project in the context of internationalisation, while in the third I have provided a perspective on learning for intercultural competence and cultural identity, showing that internationalisation of HE potentially provided cultural spaces favourable to the development of GC.

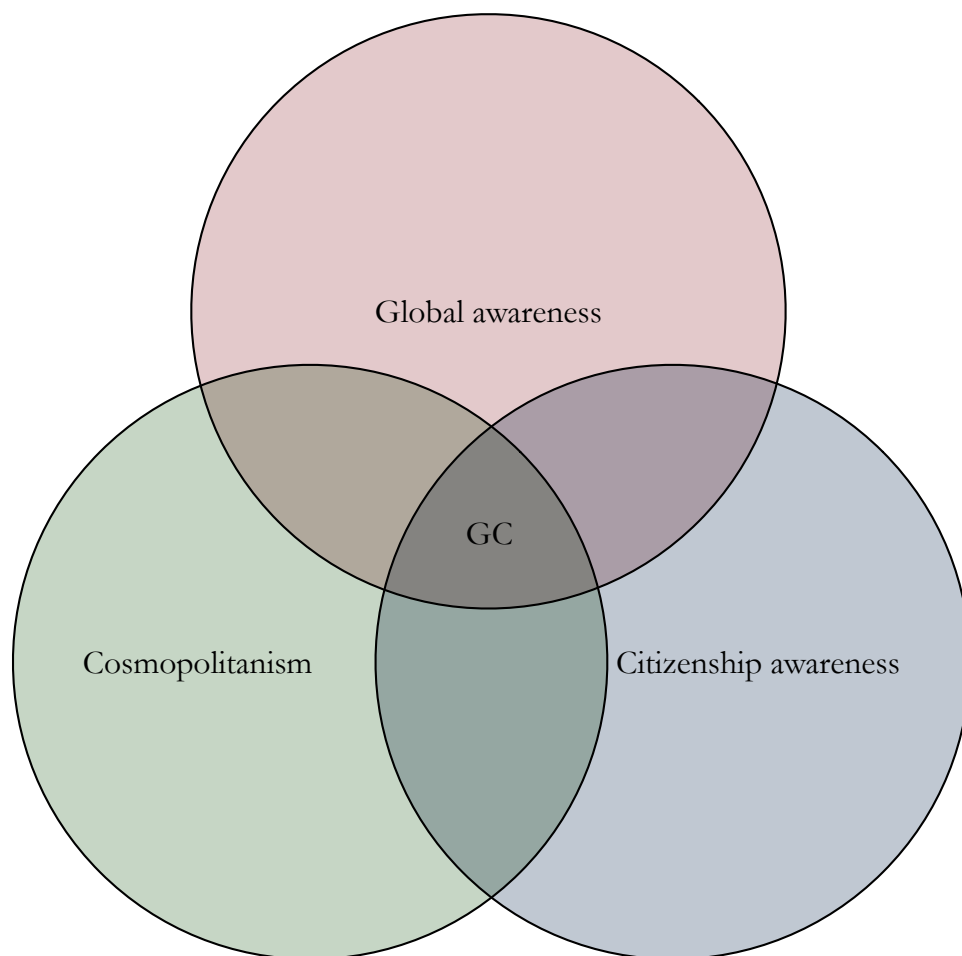
I detail below the concepts I have identified as relevant to answer my research questions:

- What are international-students' perceptions of global citizenship?
- To what extent has studying at DMU fostered global citizenship?

I also make explicit the stance I take on these theoretical issues.

#### 2.4.1. Global Citizenship

I see GC as constituted of three dimensions pertaining to attitudes and sense of place in the world: cosmopolitanism, global awareness and citizenship awareness. Figure 1 illustrates how these domains combine.



*Figure 1: Global Citizenship*

### *Cosmopolitanism*

By cosmopolitanism I understand the ability to distance oneself from one's cultural group as an exclusive site for identification (Nussbaum 1997). This understanding is indebted to classical Greek philosophers: to the Cynics who challenged social norms and collective beliefs, and to the Stoics who regarded themselves as citizens of the cosmos, rather than of the *polis* (Dower 1998). Cosmopolitanism assumes a common humanity beyond social norms and cultural differences. It can be understood as the opposite of ethnocentrism or national parochialism, and as the ability to include those who belong to other groups within the boundaries where our ethics apply (Opotow 1990).

Nevertheless, the notion of universalism that these ideas imply is problematic and should remain under critique. Western formulations of universal ideals and rights have led to the marginalisation of other epistemologies and served to legitimise colonialism and cultural racism. I follow, here, authors within the postcolonial field such as Santos (2002), Andreotti (2011) or Tully (2014) who critique self-proclaimed Western universalism. While trying to identify the basis of our common humanity, the tension between sameness and difference must remain a dialectic tool to question claims on universalism.

### *Global Awareness*

Awareness of global issues, of the interconnectedness of human societies across the planet, as well as an understanding of the local-global paradigm — recognising global issues in their local manifestations — is an essential attribute of GC, key to becoming autonomous individuals and a *sine qua non* for action.

Global awareness means recognising the legacy of colonialism on today's power structures within and across nations worldwide. This entails recognising the pervasiveness of liberalism, as an ideology that sustains capitalist social and economic order. In other words, global



awareness includes a level of consciousness that liberalism is a culturally and historically constructed set of norms, meanings and values which operates as a legitimisation of capitalism. It includes an awareness that the social organisation and modes of production imposed by globalised capitalism create global social injustice and the destruction of life on the planet.

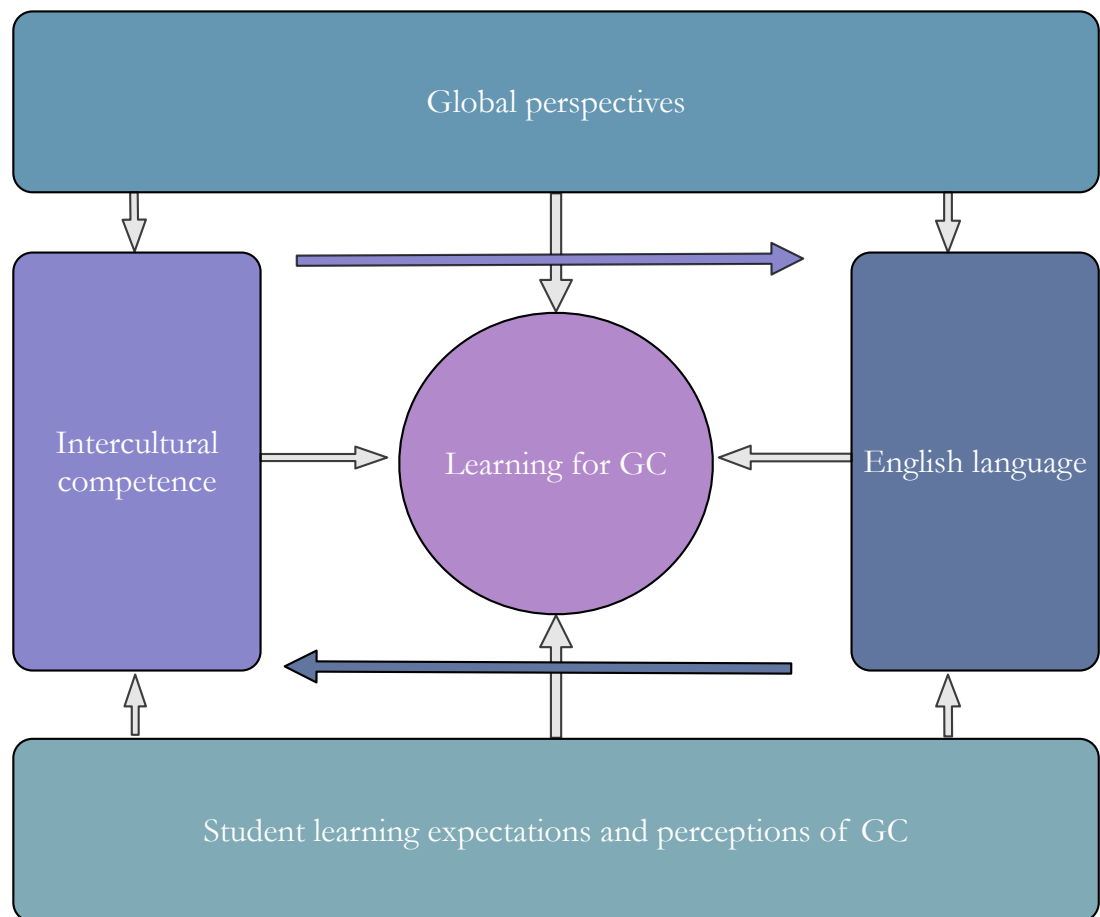
### *Citizenship Awareness*

By this I mean both the level of engagement in active civic life and the level of political literacy and perception of agency.

Citizenship is here understood as active and participative. Tully (2014) describes citizenship within a dialectical relationship between a top-down (civil) and a bottom-up (civic) form of citizenship. Civil citizenship — characterised by the constitutional rule of law and representative government enforced by a coercive authority — is the legal framework which guarantees the conservation of a capitalist and colonialist distribution of power. Social progress and emancipation will come with the exercise of civic citizenship from social forces who act for change: social, economic and political (Santos 2002; Tully 2014). This latter form of citizenship requires political literacy, awareness and skills (Osler and Kerry 2002; Andreotti 2006; Bourn 2011).

### 2.4.2. Learning for Global Citizenship

As far as learning is concerned, I identify four elements contributing to the development of GC: global perspectives, cultural competence, the role of English and student's expectations (See figure 2).



*Figure 2: Learning for Global Citizenship*

#### *Global Perspectives*

Here I look at the possibilities offered by the university to develop as a global citizen, and at the extent to which global perspectives are implemented in the curricula.

This category of analysis questions the process of internationalisation. 'Mere internationalisation' consists simply in recruiting international students while 'true internationalisation' is

characterised by the development of global perspectives (Lunn 2006: 21). The implementation of global perspectives, as a counter-hegemonic project for HE (Bourn 2011; Killick 2015), provides the opportunity for students to reflect on alternative (non-Western) ways to see and to be in the world, and conceive of alternative responses to the world challenges. This approach is in tension with the ideology responsible for the marketisation of university that tends to consider international student recruitment only for the commercial advantage they represent and promote the commodification of HE.

### *Intercultural Competence*

Cultural competence emerges from the literature as a key aspect of learning for GC. Assessing the extent to which students have improved in this domain and identifying the factors that helped and hindered learning are important aspects of this research. Cultural competence is primarily seen as the capacity to appreciate the perspective of others and to relativize one's own (Deardorff 2008).

Perceiving the situatedness of our own worldview is akin to making conscious the ideology within which we are constituted as subjects. In this regard, cultural competence is related to the above definition of cosmopolitanism; it is considered here, as a learning process. It is essential, that cultural competence is not reducible to knowledge about other cultures, as this would fail to change meaning perspectives (Mezirow 1994), and would simply define the other within existing categories of judgement (Savicki 2008).

### *English Language*

English is the language in which international students learn their academic subject and in which they socialise in cosmopolitan cultural spaces. It is also the language of the nation that colonised many of the countries from which they come, and the language of globalisation. This study is interested in how students perceive the place of English in the world and its

place in their learning project. It is assumed, for the purpose of this study, that learning and speaking English has implications on how people perceive their cultural identity.

The global spread of English makes it a candidate for being a language for GC. However, it should be considered in the light of the above argument about decolonising knowledge and challenging western ideology. Moreover, learners must appropriate English in order to use it in their own interests rather than in those of Anglo-Saxon imperialist powers (Pennycook 1998), and make it the language of globalisation from below (Guilherme 2007).

### *Students' Expectations*

Finally, I consider students' expectations of their studies in the UK. These expectations are not only illuminating about their views on some aspects of GC (in relation, for example, to the skills perceived as needed for life in the 21<sup>st</sup> century), but also determine, to an extent, the success of their learning experience. In a constructivist perspective, learning builds on pre-existent experience, knowledge and awareness. Therefore, this category combines learners' expectations and the perceptions of GC they bring to the learning process.

## Chapter 3: Methodology

In this section I describe how I carried out my research with international students at DMU. Firstly, I discuss the appropriateness of a constructivist approach in relation to the nature of the research questions and its implications for the design of the study. Secondly, I describe the context in which data were collected, including the institution and my role as a researcher, and introduce the participants. I then turn to ethical considerations and finally, to the way data were analysed.

### 3.1. Research Questions

Central to this study is the meaning of GC and how it can be a purposeful concept in the context of internationalisation of HE — one that is shared by all the actors and enhances teaching and learning, rather than one that is imposed by institutions and policy makers. Important also were the extent to which perceptions had evolved as a result of studying at DMU, and the factors that had contributed to learning. Thus the questions that structure this study are:

- What are international-students' perceptions of global citizenship?
- To what extent has studying at DMU fostered global citizenship?

In order to answer these questions, I interpret participants' attitudes towards the themes I have identified as constitutive of GC, as per my theoretical framework, as well as their reflections on their own learning and on the learning contexts. These themes function as research sub-questions:

- What are international-students' perceptions of global citizenship?
  - To what extent are their identities cosmopolitan?
  - What is their level of global awareness?
  - How do they perceive citizen action?
  
- To what extent has studying at DMU fostered global citizenship?
  - To what extent are global perspectives provided in the curricula?
  - What are participants' expectations of studying in the UK?
  - What factors have helped or hindered intercultural learning?
  - What is the role of English?

### **3.2. Research Approach**

One of the premises of the study is that social reality is co-constructed by the various actors of a social situation through their beliefs, values and representations (Neuman 2014). The study consequently adopts a constructivist orientation on social research.

Given the nature of the research questions — investigating people's perceptions of the social world and sense of identity — interviews appeared to be an appropriate means of inquiry. While there is much debate about the validity of research drawing solely on interviews as a method of data collection (Hammersley 2003), interviews can be used as an only approach if 'understood as the products of the contingencies of the interview situation' (Robson 2011: 279). Accordingly, I do not treat data as the direct expression of the informants' opinions but as co-constructed through the mediation of my own beliefs and values, relationship with the interviewees, place in the institution and stance on the issues in discussion.

Criteria for the validity of qualitative research cannot be simply transferred from the positivist paradigm. Positivism assumes a researcher who is a ‘disinterested ... pursuer of fact and truth’ (Bauman in Gee 2004: 99), who extracts knowledge from a social situation and then communicates it objectively through transparent language; this approach to knowledge assumes that a single account of social reality is possible (Bryman 2012). The constructivist approach conversely posits that knowledge is always situated, determined by the position of the researcher and laden with his values, rendering notions of replicability or generalisability non-applicable. Therefore, alternative criteria were developed that established the basis of good practice in qualitative research (Cohen, Manion and Morrison 2011).

Transparency and a reflexive stance constitute the basis upon which to judge the trustworthiness of qualitative research. A ‘thick description’ of the context must provide a database for judging the transferability of findings and conclusions (Bryman 2012), this entails a clear account of the research methods, including sampling and data analysis methods. Furthermore, disclosure of the researcher’s values, social position and involvement in the social situation under study, as well as reflection on the implications of these factors throughout the research process must constitute the basis for the acceptability of the research. The following paragraphs describe these methods.

### **3.3. Context and Sampling**

#### **3.3.1. De Montfort University — a Case Study**

DMU is a post 1992, public UK university whose policy as regards its international development, at home and abroad, is representative of the internationalisation phenomenon. 2700 students, approximately 10% of the student body, are foreign students coming from 130 countries (DMU 2015a), with a high proportion of Chinese students. DMU also runs an

international programme, DMUGlobal, ‘helping you become global graduates, equipped to meet the needs of employers across the world’ (DMU 2015b). In addition, a number of programmes are also run in partnership with international educational organisations and/or governments such as Nanjing university (DMU 2015c) or the Brazilian government through the ‘Science without Borders’ initiative (DMU 2015d) from which two participants were interviewed in this study. In sum, DMU’s ‘global outlook’ is advertised as an attractive feature for foreign and home students (DMU 2015a), and employability stands clearly as the favoured notion associated with international experience, whereby employers’ needs are given priority over, and conflated with those of students and society. DMU therefore appears as a suitable institution for a case study of how the notion of GC is constructed in internationalising universities. It is worth noting that, contrary to a number of post-1992 universities (see McKenzie et al. 2003; Bourn and Shiel 2009), DMU does not demonstrate a strong engagement with the internationalisation of the curricula or the implementation of global perspectives. As an illustration, the ‘Staff Development Matters’ programme (DMU 2016) does not feature any session related to internationalisation, intercultural teaching and learning or global citizenship.

### **3.3.2. The Researcher**

This research was made possible thanks to my involvement as an EAP tutor at DMU CELL, a department providing international students with Academic English input. As for myself, my nationality is French; English is a foreign language and I study in a UK university. I therefore seemingly share with my students, and with the participants of this study, a number of characteristics which arguably have an impact in the classroom on the type of rapport I build with students, the way I see myself within the Institution and the type of support I think I can provide. These facts about my identity can be expected to have also had an impact on what was said during the interviews.



However, in many ways, my position remains one of authority to the students. All six participants of the study had been involved with CELL and four had been my students in summer 2014. Despite my view of myself as a cultural outsider who shares this status with students and participants, I undoubtedly appear to them, however, as a representative of academic authority. I am, in fact, an insider and my foreignness is relative. My language and culture are significantly closer to English than most of my students' who may be Chinese, Thai or Arabic. Moreover, I have been their teacher and have had to grade them. I am also European, male, white and some twenty years older than most of them. In her work with international students and through her concern for ethical relationships both as a teacher and a researcher, Trahar (2011a) shows how significantly considerations of race, gender or position in the institution imbue social interactions and tinge research data produced through dialogue.

Thus my position as a researcher appears inextricably linked to my position as a teacher. It has determined both the selection of the participants and the production of the data to a degree that may have a significant bearing on the conclusions. The following describes how interviews were designed, arranged and conducted.

### **3.4. Interviews**

#### **3.4.1. Piloting the Interviews**

The interviews were conceived as semi-structured and were piloted in order to assess their feasibility and to refine their approach. Pilots were conducted over the telephone with two former students of mine from a different UK university. These students, who matched the

respondent profile I would then target (one undergraduate Iraqi and one postgraduate Chinese student), provided me with feedback and allowed me to reflect on the length of the interviews, the order of the questions, the leading character of some of them or the challenge they presented. This also highlighted the necessity to develop a more adequate strategy for eliciting perceptions germane to GC; this helped me refine and objectivise my theoretical framework.

However, whether to address the meaning of GC directly or indirectly remained a difficult question. The pilots confirmed I would meet broadly two types of situations. Either respondents have a degree of familiarity with the concept and have a representation of what it refers to, I should then discover what that is and elicit their thoughts further from there, or, the concept is unknown to them, in which case I should then probe into what I see as the perceptions and attitudes pertaining to GC, as per my theoretical framework. At this stage I saw the first situation as potentially yielding more relevant and reliable data because of the second situation risking reflecting *my* understanding of GC more than the respondents’.

Two mistaken assumptions led me to opt for the first approach. Firstly, my perception of the pervasiveness of the concept of GC in UK universities, due to my exposure to policy documents and educational discourses, deceived me into assuming international students were unlikely (despite the evidence of the second pilot) to have escaped from the realm of this rhetoric and would then have an opinion about GC. Secondly, given that the title of my research mentions GC and that interviewees would have read and signed a consent form also explicitly mentioning it, I did not deem avoidance of the term GC appropriate.

The pilots allowed for these key methodological questions to be raised, even though I eventually revised my approach after the third interview, as I explain below.

### 3.4.2. Conducting the Interviews

The approach, focus and content of the interviews continued to evolve as the research progressed. Asking from the outset what students associate with the idea of GC proved unproductive as most participants did not have a pre-existing idea, and occasionally impeded the interview process. This became apparent in Mohamed's interview and led me to move to the indirect approach.

My exchange with Mohamed emphasised this point as well as the more general issue of cross-cultural understanding and the degree to which my own perceptions were at play during these interviews. I had been concerned with the idea that some concepts have no strict equivalent in other languages and cultures, and that their use in the interviews inevitably imposed 'Western meanings' on a conversation involving people from various epistemological traditions (Santos 2002). As this concern grew, I avoided using the term citizenship altogether for example, and instead tried to elicit associated ideas pertaining to social responsibility or commitment to one's community. Valerie's interview is characteristic of this attempt at a fairer cross-cultural construction of meaning. It should be noted, nonetheless, that the language of the interviews being English meant that this attempt at cross-cultural communication was limited by the imposed Western representations and values inherent to the language.

Mohamed's interview tended to develop into a conversation where I proposed ideas to prompt his reactions and opinions. Due plausibly to a lack of fluency in English and to the challenging nature of the discussion, the interview had a laborious start, Mohamed was only producing short answers and I resorted to an unscripted approach. It appeared in retrospect that the way *I* framed the various notions in discussion was very centre stage and that the data produced in this interview were, to a significant extent, produced by the interviewer. While this is manifest in this interview, it is nonetheless true of all as it is the nature of

interviews to produce situated data resulting from researcher-participant interaction. I conducted the following interviews with a more acute awareness of this issue.

Another factor for the shift in focus of the latest interviews is my deepening understanding of some aspects of GC. Better comprehending the various ways in which questions of identity are approached within the social sciences had a decisive impact on the interview with Lena for example.

The interviews were conducted between May 14th and July 4th 2015 at DMU. They took place in undisturbed university classrooms, were audio-recorded in full and transcribed. Notes were also taken about the conditions in which each student was solicited and my impressions as to the quality of our interaction, in view of informing my reflection on each individual conversation.

### **3.4.3. The Participants**

The participant selection process involved a variety of considerations. Interviews may take a significant amount of the participants' time and the degree to which they genuinely cooperate bears significantly on the reliability of the data (Neuman 2014). Students with whom I already had built a rapport were in my view more likely to offer their time and openly discuss private and sometimes sensitive matters. I interviewed students on the basis of their availability and willingness to participate, not according to their prior knowledge, understanding or predisposition towards the idea of GC. While I did consider 'screening' participants on the basis of their attitude towards this notion through a brief survey (as did Chen 2011), I believe the idea of GC is equally relevant and potentially belongs to all students, including those who may not have been directly in contact with the way it is formally conceptualised by the Western university. One participant (Lena), however, was solicited for what seemed to me to be

a particular and interesting attitude towards citizenship. As a student, Lena had mentioned in writing her desire to make a positive contribution to Brazilian society in return for her studies abroad being funded by Brazilian tax payers. I was therefore interested in knowing more about her views on community, belonging or social responsibility. Finally, I wanted to examine various cultural perspectives and study a sample of students that would somewhat reflect the variety of nationalities and cultures present on campus. Even though this study is qualitative in its orientation and does not aim at strict representativeness and generalisability, but rather at an understanding of these six students' experience, it mattered to include voices from a range of origins.

The following lists the participants, the interview dates, and provides general contextual information.

*Khalid – 17/04/2015*

Khalid moved from Libya to pursue doctoral studies and settled in Leicester with his family. He is a 'mature student' and has been living in the UK and studying in Leicester for several years. Khalid was familiar with the concept of GC and had already reflected on the implications of the idea. Participating in an interview seemed quite natural to him as he had personal experience with social research and seemed very willing to help.

*Robert – 22/04/2015*

Robert has been my student, he is Chinese, in his early twenties, and studies a third year Business and Finance BA. Robert did not have any preconceived idea about GC, the term itself was totally unknown to him. Many of my questions challenged him, and despite the limitations of his oral expression in English the conversation yielded some insight into his experience abroad.

*Mohamed – 29/04/2015*

Mohamed is a post-graduate student in physics, he is from Saudi Arabia and had only been in Leicester for a couple of months at the time of the interview. Mohamed is a mature student and a physics teacher in Saudi's secondary education system. Despite difficulty in expressing his thoughts in depth in English, Mohamed shared his views, opinions and doubts openly.

*Valerie – 07/05/2015*

Valerie is Chinese and studies a third year Business and Finance BA. She is 22 and has been a student in my class. Valerie is a very communicative person. During our long conversation (almost an hour) she shared generously about her experience of cultural otherness, her efforts to understand and accommodate to British culture and her feelings about individual responsibility for social issues.

*Marco – 27/05/2015*

Marco comes from Brazil, he is 25 and studies pharmacy at post-graduate level with a view to continuing on to a doctoral degree at DMU. Previously my student, Marco has an interest in development, international relations, psychology and philosophy. He was comfortable with the interview as some of my questions tapped into topics he had already reflected upon.

*Lena – 04/07/2015*

Lena was my student in 2014, she is Brazilian and studies a third year BA in pharmaceutical cosmetics. Lena replied three months after my invitation to an interview, when I was no longer expecting positive replies. She wanted to have her exams out of the way before committing to anything else. Lena had been reserved in the classroom during the 2014 EAP summer course, and the interview confirmed she is an introverted and sensitive person. She did, however, share her feelings about her sense of identity and how it has evolved over the

course of this year at DMU. She reflected on her experience in a moving way, as the interview took place a week before the end of her sojourn in the UK.

### **3.5. Ethical Considerations**

Prior to any contact with participants my research proposal was revised by DMU ethics committee, and assent to conduct research on campus was obtained from the head of CELL. I supplied all the interviewees with a leaflet explaining the aims of the study, their rights to confidentiality and anonymity, their right to not answer all the questions should they feel uncomfortable, and how I would ensure the protection of these rights. The document also informed the participants about the content and length of the interview and of my intent to audio-record it. I checked the participants' understanding and agreement orally, before submitted a consent form summarising the above points for signed approval.

### **3.6. Analysis**

Interviews are analysed using thematic coding (Cohen et al. 2011). The themes used emerged from my review of the literature as the theoretical framework for this study (See chapter 2). These themes, however, were refined through the coding process itself as they were combined or divided in order to organise units of meaning across interviews, and as I shifted my focus from specific details to abstract concepts and back (Neuman 2014).

This analysis is presented in chapter 4 where each research sub-question is answered consecutively. The main research questions are answered through a summary of the answers to their respective sub-questions.

### **3.7. Limitations**

It is worthwhile noting the limitations of the study in relation to the profile of the interviewees and the type of data collected. All the participants are or have been involved with CELL, which has been a convenient setting for me to approach international students from a range of countries. However, many international students do not need linguistic support. Students from African countries for example, who may have completed secondary education at home in English and be proficient in this language, are rendered invisible in this research, whilst their views on GC would matter. Additionally, the limited fluency of some of the interviewees has also been, to an extent, an obstacle to conversations involving abstract notions and sometimes complex feelings. Some interviewees expressed their frustration in this regard. A more in-depth investigation into their perceptions and attitudes would benefit from using more varied modes of expression, e.g. writing, using the students' mother tongue or a combination of those over a period of time rather than a one-off interview.



## Chapter 4: presentation of findings

This chapter analyses the findings to both research questions. First I address question one by presenting and discussing the findings relative to each sub-question consecutively, before providing a summarised answer. I then address question two in the same fashion.

### 4.1. Question One: What are International-Students' Perceptions of Global Citizenship?

#### 4.1.1. To What Extent are Participants' Identities Cosmopolitan?

Various definitions have been given of the term cosmopolitanism. The classical definition refers to the capacity to overcome chauvinistic and ethnocentric attitudes and to include cultural others within the reach of our empathy, and to see all human being as worthy of the same dignity (Nussbaum 1997). It draws on the Cynical-Stoic tradition of distancing from the contingencies of the cultural and social norms of our accidental birthplace, and relates to the degree to which our sense of identity is equated with our sense of belonging and loyalty to one cultural group thereby stopping identification with the other, and excluding her. However, conventional meaning refers to the ability to feel at home in foreign places, and is associated with mobility beyond national borders and cultures, suggesting a form of class privilege (Caruana 2014). Both understandings are pertinent to different perspectives on GC and are not mutually exclusive.

#### *Findings*

While all participants demonstrated an attachment to their country of origin, some showed distancing, to various degrees, from their country as an exclusive site for identification. Valerie gets 'angry' when the news media report on demonstrations in Hong Kong and give a

negative image of China, which suggests her integrity as an individual is under a degree of threat when her country is denigrated. For Lena, belonging is complex. Her attachment to Brazil is beyond rational explanation, ‘despite all the problems we have, politics, violence... I like the people, the weather... I can’t explain.’ However, she identifies and relativises different sources of belonging: ‘I belong to a country but I belong to my university, to my neighbourhood ... and now I belong here in a certain way too.’ As regards a tentative meaning of GC, Lena believes ‘we all belong to Earth, we all belong to the same place.’

Loyalty is principally directed towards participants’ ‘home’ society. Although Lena’s sense of belonging is complex, she feels indebted to her country and her social responsibility naturally goes towards Brazil. As for Valerie, her feelings of compassion are spontaneously directed towards her fellow citizens, although her attitude in the interview suggests this restrictive view has been challenged. To the question whether her concern for poverty should expand beyond China, Valerie, in a self-mocking laugh ironised: ‘maybe I am not that tolerant.’

Religion appears to be a strong component of identity for Khalid and Mohamed. For Khalid, who has a long experience of living abroad, languages and life-styles can be acquired and somewhat modify our attitudes. Religion, however, is a more essential constituent of identity, and is presented as definitive:

the thing which can describe or define me, or the thing I try to keep with me all this time is my Islam, my religion. So possibly even if I go to the moon, you know, I will keep like, seeing that I’m Muslim, this is the only thing possibly I want to keep.

Mohamed, for his part, believes that a form of post-national or trans-national citizenship would only be possible among Arab countries, as different cultural and religious backgrounds would not make it viable.

Mobility and integration are also cited as central notions to life in a globalised world. People should have the right to go and live in any country (Khalid; Robert). For Robert, global citizens are people who can migrate and take their culture and language with them. Khalid uses the term integration numerous times and seems to mean both the ability for an individual to find her place in a foreign society, and the integration of all cultural groups in one global society:

It's not the first time for me to integrate, to study or to interact with English or Asian or Europeans ... People are the same, even though they have different ideologies, different religions, this doesn't prevent them from being integrated together.

### *Discussion*

The nation-state seems to remain significant to these students' sense of belonging. Some of the consequences of globalisation have been described by social theory in terms of profound social and cultural transformations signalling a shift from modernity and its social and political order based on the nation-state. Some students, indeed, have shown that their sense of belonging and identity was linked to ways of life and social practices that relativised the importance of the nation-state. Nonetheless, as is stressed by Pike (2008), nations still have a firm grip on the identity formation of their citizens through nationalist educational systems. While some students may reflect on the pertinence of national identity and begin to see it as a social construct, many demonstrate an emotional attachment that suggests a mythological role of the nation-state in their identity construction. This questions the depth and the universal character of the changes announced by social theory. The impacts of globalisation on the way people form their identities or bind to their communities are not the same across the planet. Moreover, nation-states have had very different inceptions around the world, nation-states artificially created by colonisation may have less salience than other identity markers such as religion.

There is evidence of a degree of convergence of values around a liberal version of cosmopolitanism centred on mobility, multiculturalism and integration. This convergence suggests a tendency towards the homogenisation of the values accompanying globalisation. Such a form of cosmopolitan identity seems to be cultivated by the necessity or will to work internationally, to integrate in foreign societies, or by an attitude akin to tourism and consumption of places, rather than by values of inclusion.

Despite this relative homogenisation of ways of life strong elements of identification remain: nationality, or religion. As these elements vary among students, the dialectical tension between cosmopolitan ethics and a chauvinistic identity generates different attitudes which may be ethnocentric and excluding in some cases, in others reveal the complexity and the strength of the emotions attached to one's sense of belonging. These attitudes can also be reinforced if unfamiliar social environments trigger feelings of insecurity or if identities are denigrated. This may cause the stiffening of certain aspects of identity and a protective recoil to a reassuring narrative of cultural superiority. This resonates with the work of Kinginger (2011) and with Bauman's point that 'identity only becomes an issue when it is threatened or contested in some way and needs to be explicitly asserted' (in Buckingham 2008).

Many participants, nonetheless, have expressed sympathy for universal values of brotherhood beyond differences. While these values may be weakened by parochial education and exclusive conceptions of identity, they may constitute the common ground on which to stand in order to question and deconstruct ideologies that naturalise these differences.

#### 4.1.2. What is Participants' Level of Global Awareness?

Understanding how global issues manifest themselves in local conditions, realising the interconnectedness of societies and the global nature of structures of inequality, are prerequisites to GC. Global awareness, here, refers to an understanding of globalisation processes and impacts, to an awareness of the threats posed as regards social inequality, environment damage or peace, and an understanding of the world-system as regulated by structures of domination inherited from colonisation.

##### *Findings*

While the environment and wars are perceived as the main problems for the world (Lena; Robert; Mohamed), poverty is not spontaneously mentioned. It is seen as a problem each country has to solve internally and caused by poor governance (Valerie; Marco; Lena). Business students tend to see global problems in economic terms, 'deflation in Europe..., China's economy slowing down...oil price falling down' (Valerie) while environmental degradation is associated with forms of development: 'some countries just pay attention to development, not pay attention to the environment, just like China' (Robert). However, poverty and social inequalities are themes that respondents did not instantly associate with global issues. When asked, they see their causes in inadequate governmental policies: 'I can't understand China spend a lot of money to build up so many buildings but can't they build properties for poor people?' (Valerie); 'we have really bad leaders, really bad governments in the world, ...this is a cause for poverty' (Marco). Thus the economic world system can be seen as causing environmental damage, but not social damage.

Wealth and poverty are not recognised in a systemic global relation and are sometimes seen as natural, uncaused, thereby disavowing questions of injustice. Mohamed sees the integration of all citizens of the world as unfair to people in rich countries who would then have to

share their wealth: 'if you compare between two countries like Saudi Arabia and poor country... this rich country and this poor. If I treat this people like my citizen people it is not fair.' Even when Valerie describes wealth and poverty as systemically related she does not perceive this relation as relevant at the global level. She witnessed structural social injustice both in the UK and China, nonetheless these structures are confined to closed national systems, each country having to solve its own redistribution problem.

Poverty in the developing world is attributable to people's lack of maturity and realism, while Western countries are seen as development models. The educational programme that brought Lena to the UK, aims, in her view, at developing a backward country and at reforming its traditional mentalities:

the objective is people change their minds and come back to Brazil with new ideas to change the country and change some traditional ideas that avoid the progress, the development... I hope that young people are doing the Science Without Borders programme will come back to Brazil with a desire to change things in Brazil, not to leave it behind.

Some historic perspective allows Marco to situate present development issues and past colonisation within the same picture. However, poverty is mainly due to people's passivity and immaturity, and colonisation seen as remote from today's world system:

we're talking about 500 years. So we had time to develop. But if you go to Brazil you'll find people saying it is Portugal's fault... they tend to be seated waiting something magical happen.

Although former colonising countries do have a responsibility, humans are by nature selfish and there is no benevolence, reparation or recognition of guilt to be expected:

I think people tend to go for their own interests and if we don't live in the world thinking this way, we will still have poverty. For example, I don't expect that Europe wants to help African people just because of colonisation like I'm feeling guilty or about what my ancestors they've done and I'm going to help you.

Development involves fighting in the global economy, like an adult, as opposed to expecting aid like an irrational child ‘waiting something magical happen’, Marco uses the example of Singapore:

they thought ok, we will start our own development ... and we're going to fight with the foreign market. I'm not going to wait for someone to give me things and to be good. I'm going to grow up.

External reasons are then dismissed, nothing other than people’s inadequate understanding of human nature and reality explains poverty in the developing world. Even though Marco recognises that yesterday’s injustice has disadvantaged some countries for today’s competition, globalisation is nonetheless a new game, colonisation is about our ‘ancestors’, some ‘500 years’ ago.

### *Discussion*

There is here strong evidence for what Spivak calls ‘epistemic violence’ (in Andreotti 2006): the universalisation of Western values and interests. Thus, the global economic model is not seen as creating inequalities. The capitalist model of development imposed in an asymmetric power-relation to poor countries after WWII is seen through an ideology that disavows exploitation and injustice: capitalism is the way out of poverty; if poverty endures, it is because people do not engage with market economy properly, or because inadequate governments do not redistribute the wealth created. The ideology concealing the exploitative nature of capitalism naturalises this model, and at the same time naturalises the cultural differences constructed within discourses of moral superiority and racism. A significant amount of data, here, illustrates that accepting Western development as a model implies that those on a different course of history are backwards, that traditional ways of thinking are a handicap, and social and economic difficulties of developing countries are a result of “cultural characteristics”. Stereotypes constructed within colonial discourses where indigenous people are portrayed as childish, irrational or lazy (Pennycook 1998) are thus internalised and perpetuated

by those they marginalise. In Spikav's theory, geographic positioning is nonetheless not as important as class culture in the reproduction of this ideology (Andreotti 2006). It is reasonable to think that the students from developing countries who can afford to study in UK universities belong to social classes that regard Western values favourably, as they legitimise their position of domination as the *élite* (or *élite-to-be*) of their countries. Rizvi (2005) makes similar observations about foreign students in Australia.

Two important relationships are not acknowledged in participants' perceptions of globalisation: the continuity of a world system which has come into being through centuries of colonisation, and the systemic relations between societies across the globe within the current global economic order.

#### **4.1.3. How do Participants Perceive Citizen Action?**

This section presents participants' perceptions of citizenship and discusses them within a dialectic of agency and structure of power as described by Tully (2014), whereby a hegemonic, modernist and liberal form of containment is opposed to the resistance of emancipatory social movements and practices — civil v. civic citizenship.

#### *Findings*

Achieving personal success, academic and professional, is seen as the most appropriate way to contribute to society. Being a health professional has always seemed to Lena as a privileged way to improve society: 'I believe I maybe can change the world [laughs] with my profession in the future'. Lena feels she can best contribute to Brazilian society by importing techniques and knowledge from the West. In the same way, Mohamed's contribution to his country is to import knowledge from the 'big country in education and science like UK and USA': 'I



will take this information for my home and for my students there, because I'm a teacher in technical college in Saudi Arabia'.

Valerie thinks the best way she can contribute to combatting poverty in China is by creating wealth herself and be a successful business woman:

If one day I can become rich .... help poor people and do something to contribute this society. This is my thinking, this also is a reason why I come to here study and get my qualification.

However, she feels individuals have limited power and that addressing inequalities is a job for governments:

I think government should care about these things.... Our power, like my parents, they really want to help some poor students, like my father now, raised money to help students to get to university. We are not powerful, I think government is powerful, they have lots of money.

When asked further about her citizen responsibility on a global level Valerie seems overwhelmed by such a burden:

I'm a student, I just you know like be a good student and do my MA and just you know maybe I can stay here and do some contribution like research ...if I do my business and make money I'll have so many employees, this is contribution! (Exclamation mark reflects the interviewee's conclusive tone of voice).

For Marco, the duty of the individual resides chiefly in educating him or herself, realising the true nature of reality, helping others realise it too, and striving for success. Marco's view on poverty and what impedes development in former-colonised countries, is centred on the will of the individual and the duty to self-betterment, and self-education. Our responsibility towards the community is tied to our responsibility for our own enlightenment, awakening from the delusion that people are good and becoming adults. The best contribution to society 'is to help people to understand that'.

Individuals are sometimes seen as having cross-border agency over governments although for some participants, citizenship is confined to the nation-state. Khalid sees national borders (and ideological barriers) as artificially created by governments, they should not prevent people from campaigning for global rights such as the freedom of speech or the freedom of movement. Global citizens have responsibility for peace and world poverty. Mohamed on the other hand seems to see national borders as the ultimate frontier for civic life, and GC an educational utopia: 'governments is not good for global citizens, just education talk that...we need some papers passports, I mean borders not cancelled.'

### *Discussion*

A sense of powerlessness dominates students' perceptions of action towards social change. They mostly surrender to a top-down form of citizenship, a liberal form which enforces the legal framework for 'free trade' (Tully 2014), and promotes the idea that freedom and emancipation reside in individual (economic) success.

Social injustice might be perceived as needing addressing, but responses come within the narrow possibilities offered by this framework. Thus, some students see their own success in the business world as the appropriate answer, following the principle according to which if the few get richer, all will benefit. Charity is another common response. Charity might alleviate guilt and provide some help, but does not question social structures and their reproduction. Finally, promoting education is perceived as a way to improve society and people's lives, but students, here again, project the dominant values as well as their own experience and expectations: education should help people develop businesses, enter the global market, find jobs in international corporations, or realise the true nature of people as essentially governed by their self-interests.

Data, here, in line with Osler and Kerry's (2002) conclusions, show that while injustice may trigger feelings of outrage, lack of understanding of 'how the world works' — of political literacy — condemns these feelings to be resolved in charity rather than civic action. The possibility of campaigning internationally for Human Rights and against poverty has been mentioned, but only marginally, and as an abstract, theoretical way of universalising liberal rights. Being a member of a union or of an NGO campaigning for social rights and/or contesting the hegemonic power of world capitalist institutions (IMF, World Bank, WTO, etc.) is beyond participants' perceived range of possible actions.

Nation-states' borders are perceived as the limits to the exercise of citizenship, since civil, national citizenship dominates subjectivities. Civic citizenship, on the other hand, requires a desire for emancipation and the conquest of new rights. It requires political imagination and creativity which are not encouraged by the ideology in charge of maintaining existing political structures. The lack of awareness of the economic and political interconnectedness of the world, combined with a narrow sense of citizenship imposed by, and limited to their respective nation-states, prevents students from imagining and enacting GC.

#### **4.1.4. Conclusion and Answer to Question One**

The first research question sought to understand how participants see themselves in the world in relation to their sense of belonging, their perceptions of global issues, and their role in responding to these issues. Interviews demonstrated various attitudes towards cosmopolitanism, and evidenced that prejudice can be rooted in different forms of identification. Although they all demonstrated an attachment to their home country, some showed signs that exclusive belonging to national groups could be subject to negotiation. For others however,

religious allegiance appeared as a more essential constituent of their identity. Moreover, international mobility appears to be a significant aspect of participants' perception of a liberal global-citizen life driven by the need, or aspiration, to be part of a transnational work force.

Students' worldviews are significantly dominated by Western values and ideology. The hegemonic economic system remains unquestionably the only development model, and contribution to society equates to importing Western knowledge and values to their home countries. It is also noteworthy that social injustice is not perceived as a global problem but as one to be addressed within each nation. Moreover, poverty is seen as the result of poor governance rather than of unfair structural conditions. This suggests a lack of awareness of the world economic and political system and how it came into being, mirrored in the relative powerlessness students demonstrate regarding possibilities for action. Accordingly, the responses that may be envisaged to redress injustice do not address structural causes, and citizenship is uncritically conceived of within a narrow liberal perspective that does not question the premises of the hegemonic economic order.

## **4.2. Question two: To What Extent has Studying at DMU Fostered Global Citizenship?**

The remainder of this chapter presents and discusses the findings relative to the second research question. It addresses the factors that helped or hindered student development as global citizens.

### **4.2.1. To What Extent are Global Perspectives Provided in the Curricula?**

In this section I consider participants' perceptions of their courses and the extent to which appropriate opportunities to develop as global citizens are provided, both in terms of content

and learning situations — the extent to which the university has provided global perspectives rather than mere internationalisation (Lunn 2008; Bourn 2011).

### *Findings*

Globalisation does not seem to be addressed in its full significance. Every discipline has specific topics pertaining to various aspects of globalisation. For example, business studies addresses questions such as Chinese economic growth, Euro Zone deflation, etc., while pharmacy addresses issues pertaining to industry and technology. Lena reports that the pharmaceutical industry is increasingly globalised, that Brazil imports most of its medical technology from the West and in this regard, her course does address globalisation. A significant portion of her course is nonetheless centred on local regulations: ‘some modules are very related to UK regulations, so in this respect I didn't learn much about other places.’ In these curricula, current social and cultural transformations and their relevance to students’ lives do not seem to be considered. Lena comments: ‘I think it's not obvious in my course. Because it's very, hmm, it's more like science, it's not like human social course. So I didn't think the teachers focused on these aspects.’

Courses provide contrasting experiences in terms of cultural diversity. Valerie depicts her experience working with others in very positive terms. She uses the pronoun *we*, to refer to her Chinese classmates when describing the support British students provide: ‘we like make groups with local people, native speakers, because, ... really helpful, they're still really happy to help us, they're really friendly’, or from an African student (Valerie did not remember which country) with whom pressure-free communication in English seems to have been particularly rewarding: ‘she can speak really good English and if we can't understand she will explain and, if we don't understand we won't pretend, we would say “what do you mean?”... she will explain to us.’

Lena, on the other hand, did not take advantage of the presence on her course of other nationality students to experience intercultural cooperation. Intercultural competence was apparently not part of her teachers' aims. Half the students were Brazilian and although the course comprised instances of group work, students were free to choose their partners. As a result, Lena's reluctance to get out of her 'comfort zone' led her to only work with Brazilians classmates: 'I don't remember working with people that are not Brazilian.... I didn't expand my perspective in this respect... I was in my comfort zone I think.'

On a 'very multicultural course', Marco's experience of group work revealed enriching to his understanding of situated approaches to pharmacy. Group work has been the opportunity to confront different priorities in research worldwide as students had to decide on research topics collectively. Thus Marco describes how students from poorer nations tend to prioritise

Neglected diseases...they're different from common diseases like diabetes or cardiovascular problems...related with wealthy nations. Because in poor nations you don't have this type of problems.

However, Marco's comments suggest that these discussions have sometimes been perceived by his lecturer as disrupting his lesson plan.

### *Discussion*

Judging from these students' accounts, there is no evidence that global perspectives are a feature of their programmes. Neither the content of these courses nor the way they are delivered suggest a reflexive attitude towards Western knowledge, values, conceptions of education, or the inclusion of non-Western perspectives.

Globalisation and its effects impact every discipline of knowledge and in this regard are dealt with in most courses. However, a Western perspective on globalisation is presented and

Western interests privileged. This is illustrated by the testimony of pharmacy students. Pharmacy is seen, and taught, from the perspective of the industry and the economic interests of a handful of Western firms exporting their products and technology, rather than from the perspective of health needs around the world. Moreover, the accent is put on UK health regulations. While this is undoubtedly a necessary feature of a UK course, a contextualisation within World Health Organisation policies and an understanding of differentiated health needs would provide a richer, more world-minded approach. Global perspectives are not about looking at the whole world from one point of view but rather looking at the world from multiple points of view. The need to systematically integrate the global dimension within pharmacy education in the UK has been underlined by Murdan et al. (2014) who show that global perspectives are only provided by lecturers who have developed a personal interest in global issues.

What is more, the emphasis on subject content marginalises learning outcomes related to cross-cultural cooperation and intercultural competence. Evidence shows that those are not articulated teaching aims and that learning in these areas is not given much attention. As a result, some students can simply avoid working with peers from other parts of the world. At the same time, when conditions are met for intercultural cooperation to happen, the richness of diverse perspectives on the subject matter are relegated to the margins, since unexpected discussions and cultural dissonance seem to slow down the execution of a lesson plan concerned with more instrumental aims.

#### **4.2.2. What are Participants' Expectations of Studying in the UK?**

In assessing participants' change of perception, it appeared useful to consider their expectations in terms of learning and skills, prior to moving to the UK. These expectations provide

insight into how they see the role of international HE, its relation with globalisation and life in the 21st century.

### *Findings*

Skills that are perceived as key by participants include language and communicative skills as well as study skills and critical thinking. There is unanimity about the importance of English as a tool for international communication, and of cultural awareness. The latter is reflected in students' responses in terms such as tolerance and respect for, or understanding of others, and for Marco, of recognition of 'the truth of others', i.e. cultural perspectives. Furthermore, access to other languages such as 'French, Spanish or Arabic' for example, as a means to facilitate people's mobility and 'integration' is stressed by Khalid, who also notes that personal skills enhancing communication are decisive assets on the globalised labour market:

If for example you want to work in a country, in a company, in a factory, if you don't have the skill to work like, as a team, like team work and the skills to communicate with other people, possibly this will impact negatively on the company.

Critical thinking is mentioned by Marco and Valerie as a key competence pertaining to emancipation and political awareness. Marco insists that reading critically, questioning texts, is a skill that allows students to continue learning after university, and to emancipate from thinking patterns imposed by technique.

I think it's the most valuable thing you can learn because, yeah, you can learn techniques in uni, but if you don't learn how to read, how to think, you will just know the technique for the rest of your life but you'll never be able to develop. If you don't have the technique but you have the thinking, you can learn everything.

Reading uncritically leads to 'a cheaper understanding of what is there'. Furthermore, Marco links reading and critical thinking to political literacy as the only way to understand what motivates people and what rules the world: there is a 'cheap' and a critical reading of the world. Valerie, on her part, stresses the importance of decoding the media. She uses the



expression 'In China, we really live in our news' to refer to the lack of criticality of a population adhering to the rosy picture television paints of China. The imposed narratives that shape people's perceptions of the world need to be countered by critical thinkers:

we think UK is very dangerous place, why? because we heard some news it's like some international students died and some people killed a girl when they do their master... You need critical thinking and hmm, you can't believe everything the news tell you and, you need to think by yourself it's really important.

A shared expectation of studying in the UK, as regards skills, involves the idea that the Anglo-Saxon world in general possesses more advanced and more useful knowledge and that UK universities are more efficient. Students report that they want to bring back knowledge to their less developed countries. For Mohamed, the UK and the US are more advanced scientifically and this is the main reason he studies physics in Britain; Lena wants to import modern ideas and techniques. The global economic lead of the Anglo-Saxon world is also an attractive factor for students. Valerie and Robert expect more work opportunities in the financial sector while Marco expects to gain knowledge of his discipline from a more business-oriented perspective: 'In what I really was expecting, is this view of corporation view, you see pharmacy through the eyes of industry, in Brazil we don't have this approach, we really focus on health.' Marco and Lena have also mentioned differences between Brazilian and British university life as regards organisation of studies and autonomy, aspects from which they were expecting to learn.

### *Discussion*

Students' expectations of studying in the UK, in terms of skills and knowledge, tend to reinforce two assumptions underpinning neoliberal globalisation. First, that the West has more useful, more advanced knowledge and that it is the only model for the development; second, that the role of education is merely to prepare for employment. Students unanimously think

that a UK university will better prepare them for employment, as regards subject expertise, intellectual rigor and the acquisition of the English language. While this statement may appear as a truism (since otherwise they would not choose to study in the UK), it contains assumptions which ought to be questioned in the context of these studies. First, the colonial dichotomy between a developed and rational West and a non-Western world that needs to get out of ‘childhood’ and to ‘catch up’ is re-asserted. Second, it naturalises the vocational orientation of HE as its agenda is set by private corporations, and as UK universities are marketed overseas for the comparative advantage they confer in terms of employability.

Criticality is nonetheless valued by some students who develop the ability to think autonomously. This disposition for critique, however, appears to be mostly grounded in a liberal understanding of critical thinking. ‘Liberal’ critical thinking operates within the paradigm of Western liberal humanism and can be defined as the ability to argue, reason and debate, to emancipate from illusion, through reason (Pennycook 2001). A radical approach to the term ‘critical’ however, is more specifically concerned with relations of power and with the deconstruction of the modernist notion of Cartesian subjectivity (Pennycook 2001; Andreotti 2011). Evidence suggests an awareness of the relation between the way worldviews, subjectivities and opinions are formed and the power of the narratives we are exposed to, notably in the media. This scepticism towards the ‘truth’ produced by discourse (Foucault 1971) suggests an aptitude for ‘critical literacy’ which remains unexplored within curricula.

#### **4.2.3. What Factors have Helped or Hindered Intercultural Learning?**

Intercultural competence has been described as the ability to change one’s frame of reference in order to more fully understand, and include, the way others see the world, and to relativize one’s situated point of view (Deardorff 2008). It is fundamental in recognising a diversity of ways of living, of seeing, and being in the world and imagining alternative futures (Andreotti

2011). This section describes some of the factors that have contributed to the participants learning in this area.

### *Findings*

Marco's participation in culturally diverse work groups seems to have reinforced his pre-existing prejudice. His sensitivity to questions of perspective has allowed him to make sense of different approaches to research in pharmacy and to relate them to issues of development. He also noted that attitudes towards work are somehow determined by cultural traits. The striking correspondence with his earlier description of development issues suggests strong stereotypes prejudice his judgement — Westerners are achieving, Asians are dedicated and Brazilians are lazy.

Some people here they really work hard, they want to do the best they can do. Like from what I've heard it's a lot like the US. they really are... they just stop when they have the maximum. In Brazil you don't have that culture. We're used to do the sufficient, not the maximum....It's interesting to see different patterns of behaviour, like you can see the Chinese they're really shy, they don't talk too much but they really do their task at the final limit, and other guys they don't really care about it.

Although Lena has not taken advantage of multicultural group work, her experience at DMU has been the occasion to reflect on her identity. Lena's timidity prevented her from leaving her 'comfort zone', and she expressed regrets in this regard. However, this very introversion might have been the ground for reflexive thinking on questions of community, belonging and identity. While it is difficult to identify clear learning outcomes, this exposure to foreignness seems to have been an existential experience likely to change the way Lena sees herself in the world.

I have a feeling of not belonging to any country anymore. ... Before I'm Brazilian I think I belong to Brazil. Or now I belong to UK, now it's all mixed up this

feeling of belonging. It's strange, because of this I think it will be difficult to readapt to Brazil.

Discussing global citizenship and the possibility of a bond that unites all humanity, Lena comments:

For me, now that I've lived abroad, I can feel this, but I think for some people they don't feel it yet, because I think in general people would like to feel that they belong to a group but sometimes it's bad ... because you don't see other people like your brother of human being.

Valerie seems to have experienced learning in a more rounded way as she has taken advantage of multicultural study situations, socialised outside the university and reflected on the way her perceptions have changed. Studying in culturally diverse settings has been a very positive experience as Valerie describes. Nonetheless, it is life outside university that seems to have yielded deep and transformative learning. Valerie describes how confronting her values about society with those of young British friends she made in Leicester resulted in a disheartening situation where understanding seemed to rely on much more than effective communication. Valerie does not understand why some working-class British people might feel resentful towards their government and towards what they perceive as the ruling class. Valerie's attitude towards work, money and success is different as well as her view on power, government and agency. Valerie fails to find a shared view point with her friends and expresses frustration:

they don't like government something, and they want freedom. I just don't care about this, why should I care. I told them I think freedom is not like hmm, you know, your government give you like so many limitations and they just want to control you... I think the freedom you give to yourself, not somebody else give to you, it's just you know like, mmm, can't understand me, can't understand my thinking.

Valerie recognises how cultural differences prevent us from accessing the other's point of view. Interestingly, she locates these differences both in social-class and national culture.

I think the background, you know like, where you're from, culture things, can cause so many issues, with communicate ways, from people from different country and background. I think value things are important and hmm, maybe most of my British friends, they are not from a middle class or like rich family.

While cultural differences may seem to have occasionally rendered mutual understanding impossible, the meaningfulness of the relationship Valerie has forged — including a romantic relationship — with Leicester people has nevertheless allowed her to appreciate the perspective of her friends, reassessed her somewhat privileged social condition and become aware of its significance in forming judgements.

Before I came here I just think every British they're really rich. ... Now I come here, and I find it's not right. ...most of my British friends, they didn't get financial support from their family when they do their degree. But it's different in China, we get financial support from our family. My parents told me, you just need to concentrate on your course and finish you study and come back.

Valerie's experience seems to have transformed her deeply and involved a critical reflection on values and on the way judgements are formed. For the other participants however, cultural competence seems to be merely associated with knowledge about a target culture, in order to be able to 'integrate' (Khalid; Robert), to expand knowledge about others (Khalid; Mohamed) or to communicate more efficiently in work environments (Robert; Khalid). Transformation of the self is not significantly part of the experience.

### *Discussion*

A significant outcome of these interviews is the evidence that studying abroad and exposure to cultural diversity does not yield, in itself, learning in terms of intercultural competence. This corroborates abundant literature interrogating the conditions that can tackle prejudice in educational settings (See for example Bennet 2008; Hunter 2008; Caruana 2014; Killick 2015). 'Prejudice is only reduced by sustained intercultural contact that reaches below the surface and involves groups of people who enjoy equal status in the pursuit of common

goals' (Allport in Caruana 2014: 90). Importantly, an additional necessary condition is a reflexive attitude to learning which can challenge students' assumptions and modify 'meaning perspectives' (Mezirow 1994). Intercultural competence is primarily the ability to recognise how our own ways of living, thinking and judging are cultural and contingent. When intercultural learning is seen, as it is often the case, as knowledge about the culture of others, it may lead to a sentiment of 'expertise' without the situatedness of our own point of view ever being questioned.

Interviews have also produced the evidence that intercultural learning does happen, albeit incidentally. The experience of some participants demonstrates the importance of emotional commitment to a form of learning that exceeds mere intellectual and rational engagement. This substantiates research promoting an experiential and affective approach to learning for intercultural competence (Savicki 2008) and the broadening of our understanding of intelligence to include emotional intelligence (Goleman 1995), as such profound learning experiences will shake our sense of identity. Contact with local people, if meaningful, can lead international students to deeply question the cultural and social origins of their values. This can be a difficult, painful process. Interviews have shown a diversity of attitudes towards difference, foreignness and behavioural responses to challenging situations, as well as a variety of variously successful learning strategies people adopt to overcome cultural dissonance. They do not evidence, however, the commitment of the university to support these aspects of learning.

#### **4.2.4. What is the Role of English?**

English plays an important role in the development of a cosmopolitan culture. As argued in chapter 2, its development as a language fit for GC depends on its appropriation by those

who have been ‘othered’ by it (Singh et al. 2002). This section looks at students’ perceptions of English and its role in their studies.

### *Findings*

English is unanimously perceived as the ‘international’ (Robert), ‘universal’ (Lena) or ‘global’ (Khalid) language and therefore an indispensable skill for life. Lena highlighted the predominance of English in the world of research and scientific knowledge, and the necessity to be literate in this language to access this knowledge. Khalid and Robert stressed the importance of English as a competence for employability and mobility in a world where people may have to live in foreign places.

For Khalid, there is an evident, although repressed, relationship between past colonisation and today’s global economic regime. Empowerment involves employability on the global market, which is itself conditioned by literacy in the languages of former colonial powers. Khalid raised this issue but immediately signalled reluctance to carry on with a sensitive topic:

this is something to do with colonialism, with the past or something. But you know, let us keep ourselves from politicians something. English is spoken everywhere in the world, so it's important to be capable to speak in the language or understanding it or writing it, because most of the companies, they interact in English, so mastering this language is something important, it possibly gives you the chance to find a job, to get what you want.

An important aspect of the context in which English is practised at university concerns co-operation amongst students and the inclusion of non-native speakers. In this regard, Valerie’s comments on her collaboration with an African student (see 4.2.1.) suggests communicating was somehow more gratifying and productive than with local students.

### *Discussion*

In the same way that globalisation is not seen as the result of a historical process beginning with colonisation, the English language is mostly naïvely perceived solely as a convenient international tool for communication. The status the language has gained in all domains of international affairs has made it an indispensable asset for the economic autonomy of individuals, but also for the circulation of knowledge, trans-national cooperation and active global citizenship. Nonetheless, an uncritical approach to English in the context of international education contributes to the naturalisation of the hegemony of Western culture, knowledge and political interests. Evidence suggests that the problematisation of this state of affairs is possible but seems to be met with a sense of powerlessness and the feeling that politicising these issues is irrelevant as it will only arouse passions about an irrevocable past. The choice made by students, and arguably encouraged by the institution, to focus on a pragmatic and instrumental approach to their studies and to English, contributes to the denial of the legacy from colonisation to current power structures.

Some data indicates that the cooperation in English among non-Western students favours the appropriation of the language. By appropriation, here I refer not merely to linguistic proficiency, but to the capacity to engage with the power relations imposed by the language and the cultural constructs embedded in the discourses with which English has become linked (Pennycook 1998; Singh et al. 2002; Guilherme 2007). The case of Valerie reporting on a particularly rewarding collaboration with an African classmate, being due to the absence of pressure to be a performant speaker, suggests that there is more than just language fluency at play. Graddol (2006: 115) argues that intercultural communication in English is likely to be more effective without the presence, the “hindrance”, of native-speakers. His argument, however, remains at the level of linguistic proficiency. I want to suggest that these students, being non-white, non-male and non-western, have found a space in which to use English



outside the rules regulating the language as an institution — grammatical, but more importantly cultural and therefore ideological rules. The conditions for the development of a global English fit for global citizens might lie within such spaces. This raises the question of native speakers themselves engaging with questions of ownership of the language and with the racist and sexist constructs embedded in it, in order to open up to the world.

#### **4.2.5. Conclusion and Answer to Question Two**

The second research question has sought to assess the extent to which participants have developed their global-citizen identity at DMU, and to identify factors that facilitate or impede learning.

The implementation of global perspectives in the curricula is not evident and internationalisation seems reduced to the mere recruitment of overseas students, without adequate structures for genuine inclusion or global learning. Intercultural competence seems relegated to incidental learning. As a consequence, the mere co-existence of multiple cultures in the classroom runs the risk of reinforcing prejudice. Learning for intercultural competence appears to be complex and to rely on multiple factors, including elements of reflexivity as well as emotional commitment. The integration of students within meaningful social contexts and their capacity to reflect on the feelings triggered by cultural dissonance are critical. Another consequence of market-driven policy and of the university's commitment to employability is the lack of critique of the ideology legitimising western hegemony. Students' utilitarian expectations of HE tend to reinforce this ideology, and few participants have demonstrated a critical attitude towards their own judgement or their own learning experience. As for the English language, it is legitimately perceived as a key competence for life in a global world. Evidence of its development in an ethos of inclusion and its contribution to a GC culture and identity is limited, yet observable.

## Chapter 5: Conclusion

### 5.1. Introduction

This study was set out to explore perceptions of GC amongst international students at DMU and to identify the factors that influence international-students' development as global citizens in the context of their studies. Given, on the one hand, the growing number of non-European students on British campuses, and on the other, the increasing presence in HE of a rhetoric of globalisation, this research proposed to give these students a voice in order to construct, with them, a meaning for the term 'global citizen' that would not be exclusively informed by Western representations of the world. The study was structured around two research questions. What are international-students' perceptions of GC? To what extent has studying at DMU fostered GC?

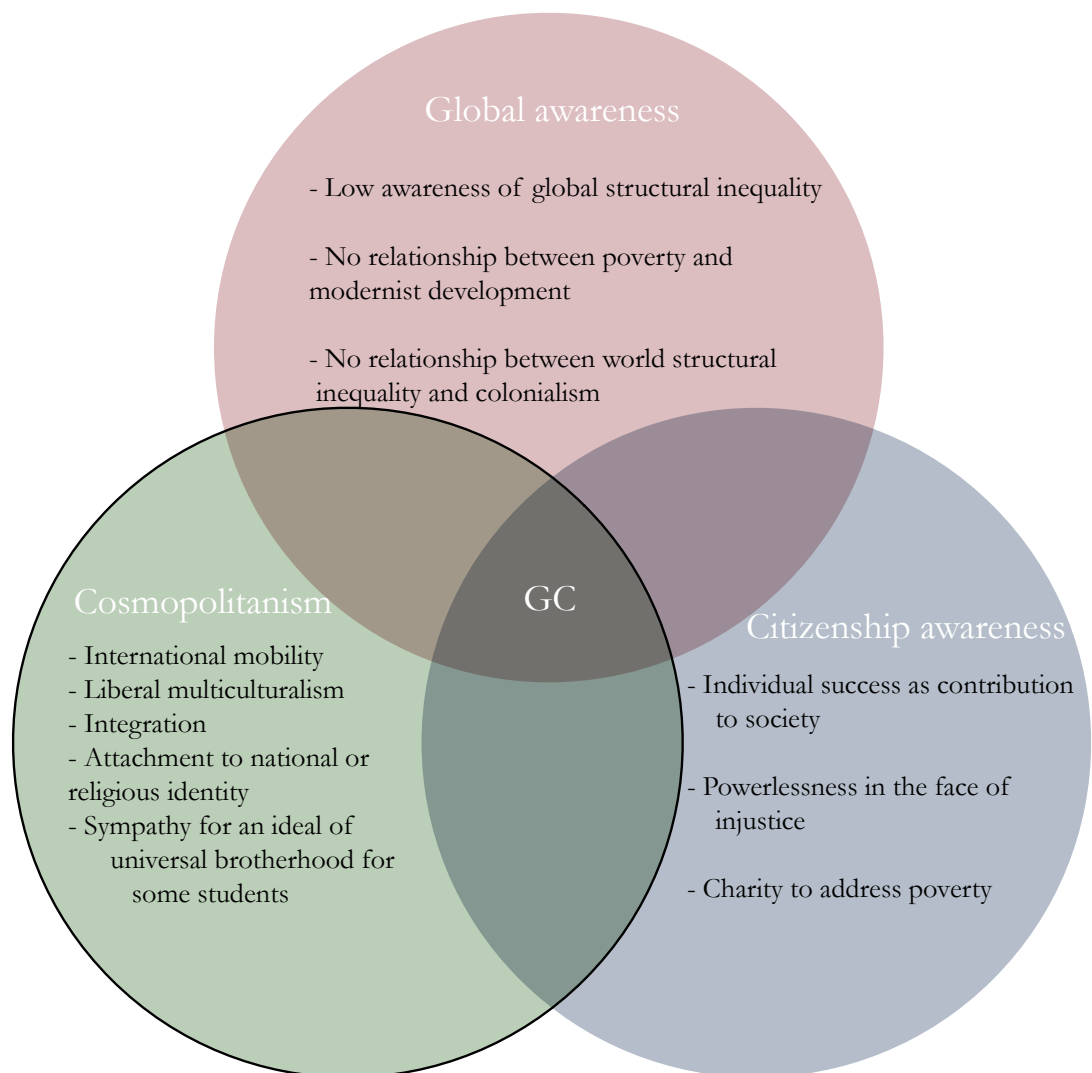
I adopted a constructivist approach in order to give an interpretative account of participants' assumptions, values and perceptions. I conducted 6 interviews with under- and post-graduate students from China, Brazil, Libya and Saudi Arabia. To analyse the data, I have used a theoretical framework that defines GC as the combination of attitudes including a sense of cosmopolitanism, an awareness of the global condition of the world and a sense of citizenship and civic engagement. Learning for GC is seen as being conditioned both by students' expectations and by the context provided by the university as seen from these students' perspectives. The extent to which this context includes a global perspectives approach, the role of the English language in students' cultural identity as well as intercultural competence are the areas I have examined to address this second question.

This chapter draws together the key findings of the research in order to produce a overall answer to the research questions. It then provides a reflexive discussion of the rationale of

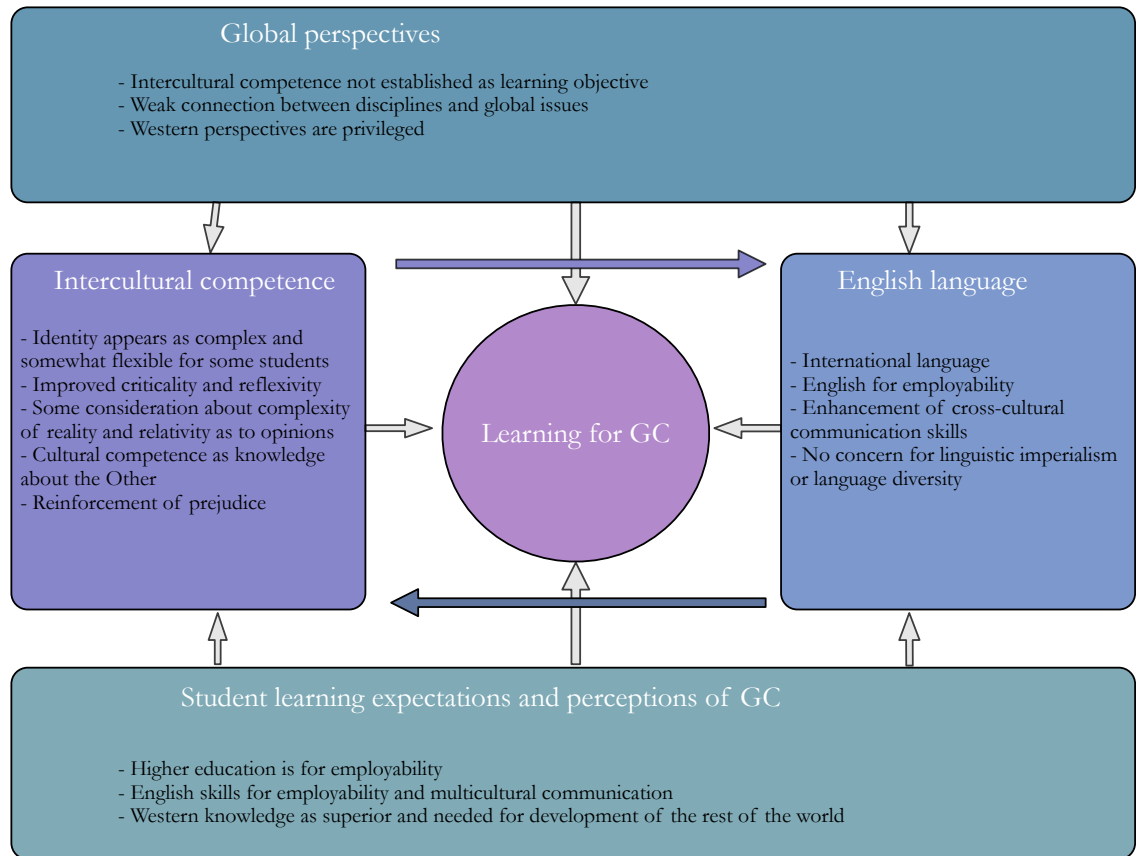
the study in the light of these findings and relates it more widely to the challenges facing the implementation of global perspectives in HE. Finally, it makes a number of recommendations regarding GCE in the context of internationalisation of HE, at DMU, and beyond.

## 5.2. Findings

Figures 3 and 4 display a summary of the perceptions and attitudes most salient in the interviews.



*Figure 3: Perceptions of Global Citizenship*



*Figure 4: Learning for Global Citizenship*

Evidence shows that while some participants have a relative sense of cosmopolitanism based on a humanist ideal of common humanity and liberal multiculturalism, empathy towards people outside their national groups is limited. Data show that this limitation of identification to a wider community may rest on nationality but also on religion. It appears that an important driver for a cosmopolitan attitude of openness to other cultures is the notion of international mobility, perceived as a requirement for today's professional life.

Participants' awareness of global issues and of the interconnectedness of societies, of the systemic relations between different parts of the world engaged in the globalised economy, and of the historic and political conditions of existence of this system proved to be weak. Students' worldviews are dominated by Western representations of modernist development,

and by assumptions inherited from colonialism whereby the West possesses *knowledge*, while others possess *traditions* that are a hindrance to development and a cause for poverty. Importantly, world poverty is not seen as the result of an unfair economic order but of inadequate adaptation to it. Therefore, political change on the global scale does not appear as a necessity. What is more, this view is accompanied by a sense of citizenship which discards possibilities of civic actions for the claim of rights, and the mobilisation of social forces for political change.

Interviews did not produce much evidence that the programmes in which participants are integrated provide global perspectives, and intercultural competence does not emerge as an established learning outcome in their university experience. The views presented by their courses, both on globalisation and on the disciplines themselves, seem to remain largely dominated by Western representations and Western interests, while the current transformations of the social world and their impacts on students' future do not appear as valued areas of reflection.

There is clear evidence, however, that the lack of attention given to intercultural competence results, for some students, in the reinforcement of prejudice. It also appears that a form of prejudice rooted in internalised Western racist representations is not only reinforced by the absence of appropriate engagement with intercultural learning, but also reinforced by the university's endorsement of neoliberal values which tend to naturalise these representations. For some students, this experience abroad has nonetheless occasioned valuable learning about what determines people in their thinking and judgement, or in their experience of identity.

As regards English, it is acritically seen as the necessary language that permits international communication. This research has not produced clear evidence that learning English (or *in* English) has had notable effects on students' cultural identity and sense of place in the world beyond the immediate enhancement of their capacity to communicate across cultures.

This study began with the assumption that the term global citizen, as part of a rhetoric of Western educational policies, was bound to be laden with Western representations of the world. It therefore proposed to consider how the meaning of GC could be more ethically constructed by including representations produced outside Western discourses.

The most important finding of this study appear to be the degree to which foreign students who come to study in the UK are already proponents of a Western model of development. This model not only consists of economic principles, but inevitably comes as part of a larger discourse regulating the relations between specific forms of knowing, forms of relating to society, to nature, and forms of subjectivities. In other words, most international students on British campuses adhere to a Western worldview; I embarked on this project in order to include voices which I finally discovered were not there — or were not telling me what I expected.

One could speculate about the reasons for this situation. Some explanations may invoke Spivak's 'epistemic violence', whereby 'the colonial power changes the subaltern's perception of self and reality and legitimises its cultural supremacy' by naturalising its cultural constructs (Andreotti 2006: 45); or Gramsci's concept of 'cultural hegemony' where hegemony means 'the success of dominant classes in presenting their definition of reality, their view of the world, in such a way that it is accepted by other classes as "common sense"' (Goldberg n.d.). Other explanations may put forward the global flow of people and ideas across Appadurai's

(1996) ‘-scapes’ or the ‘success’ of emerging countries, to account for a decentring of economic power and the emergence of capitalist élites outside the West. It may also be argued that this study has been predicated, to an extent, on the essentialist assumption that non-Western students should have non-Western values and modes of thinking. It may have assumed the existence of a traditional culture uncontaminated by Western imperialism. There remains, however, important questions for the development of a counter-hegemonic project for the internationalisation of HE: How to challenge the dominant ideology? How to bring in alternative perspectives?

### **5.3. Implications for the Implementation of Global Perspectives**

Denouncing ideology is by no means a satisfactory objective for education. However, giving students the means to understand how we are conditioned to think and to escape these determinants in order to invent a different future, is. Unconscious theoretical models of the world outside which things are either unimaginable or abnormal necessarily form the frameworks through which we make the world intelligible. Modifying these involves challenging assumptions and necessitates the contribution of alternative perspectives. Understanding how specific worldviews, through the work of history and power, can become dominant and impose one version of reality while marginalizing other versions, is also part of the desired outcomes of tertiary education for a more ethical world. These are objectives pursued by emancipatory pedagogic projects such as Freire’s (1993) or Andreotti’s (2011).

The overarching debate about the purposes of HE is essential to the implementation of global perspectives. The commitment of university to a neoliberal agenda by promoting global employability and tertiary education as economic advantage in the ‘knowledge society’, reinforces students’ assumptions as to what counts as ‘useful knowledge’ and marginalises other narratives on higher education. Andreotti (2015) speaks of ‘imaginaries of HE’ and the

different purposes HE has been imagined to have. HE can attend, for example, to the needs of the market, of the nation-state and public good, or marginalised communities. These imaginaries co-exist to different degrees in different institutions. Andreotti proposes that awareness of these imaginaries bear on policy discussions about internationalisation of HE ‘to protect the role of the university as an independent educational institution where critically informed and socially accountable discussions about alternative futures can take place’ (EIHE 2014). The implementation of global perspectives and the formation of socially responsible graduates relies to a significant extent on this level of decision.

Intercultural competence is a powerful way to learn about our unconscious theoretical models of the world. This research has shown its benefits; it has also shown some of its limitations and pitfalls. As far as students’ worldviews tend to converge on development issues, intercultural competence only goes some way to challenging Western assumptions about reality and the world. Accordingly, the inclusion of alternative perspectives seems to rely a great deal on the institution itself and on the transformation of the curricula. The presence on campus of multiple cultures does not provide, *per se*, global perspectives.

Nonetheless, beyond the status quo imposed by the current, neoliberal, phase of globalisation, there remains a variety of experiences and cultures across the world and within our universities. This study shows that positive outcomes from intercultural cooperation necessitates that learning be planned, monitored and supported by the institution. Intercultural competence must not be a by-product of internationalisation. This involves institutions themselves making their theoretical model of the world explicit, and open to examination and discussion. The ethos of an institution strongly determines the identity of its future graduates. If essentialist conceptions of culture embedded in liberal multiculturalism (Holliday



2013) and a Cartesian conception of the subject that sees knowledge as the positivist accumulation of information about the world and about the Other are not challenged, we will ‘create “experts” — students who return home from studying abroad with a “licence” to perpetuate stereotypes and biases they departed with in the first place’ (Hunter 2008: 106).

Finally, the responsibility for the implementation of global perspectives also lies a great deal on teaching staff. In order to challenge received opinions, to propose divergent perspectives and to create and nurture spaces of ethical dialogue with and amongst students, their global awareness, intercultural competence and awareness of global social responsibility are essential.

#### **5.4. Recommendations**

Based on the conclusions of this study, the following recommendations are offered for HE policy, practice and for further research.

Policy:

- Intercultural competence should be established as a learning outcome for all study programmes.
- Ongoing training and development programmes for lecturers should include GC components, intercultural teaching and learning elements and reflections about a global outlook on course contents.
- It would be beneficial to implement spaces of dialogue, reflection and reflexivity for students, within and across study programmes. These could include:

- Developing awareness of the nature of language as a system of representation constructed within situated cultural contexts.
- Developing an understanding of the working of stereotypes, their nature, how they are perpetuated and their potency in our perception of the world.
- The possibility for students to reflect on their experience in a new cultural/educational environment in relation to study, to the psychological challenges involved, questions of identity, communication, etc.

#### Practice:

- Lecturers should be guided by a concern to present multiple perspectives on course contents. They could reflect on the epistemological premises of their field of knowledge and pluralise approaches to their disciplines.
- They should encourage discussions emerging from the diversity of worldviews the student population provides on the issues raised by their disciplines.

#### Further research:

A new global culture giving rise to a new form of citizenship, fit to oppose hegemonic globalisation with 'globalisation from below' (Santos 2002), must emerge from the margins and from the least resonant voices. Therefore, in view of constructing meaning for GC that would not be laden with hegemonic representations, and learn from the presence of a variety of students on campuses, further research could:

- Widen the scope of this type of study by including participants from a larger variety of cultural backgrounds.
- Include the voice of participants from diverse social origins — not only geographic origins.
- Include participants studying in a larger selection of academic subjects.

While positing citizenship awareness and active civic participation as constitutive of GC, this research has insufficiently explored the ways in which HE may encourage them.

- Further research may question whether enhanced global awareness alone will suffice for graduates to take action.

### **5.5. Last Words**

This dissertation has taken a firm stance against current neoliberal policies of HE. There is reason to believe that HE is contributing to widening the gap between the wealthy and the poor, while it is legitimately expected to work for democratic values, peace and equality. GCE can be an approach to shifting the action of education towards the public good and inclusive democratic values — to ‘take back higher education’ (Giroux and Giroux 2004).

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## Appendices – Interview transcripts

### Interview 1 – Khalid 17/04/2015

**Researcher:** So, as you read, my research is about global citizenship. So my first question to you will be: What are your initial thoughts about GC? What do you associate with the term?

**Khalid:** Possibly something to do with globalisation. The impact of globalisation on people. Hmm... on their life style or hmm having the right to be like part of one state or part of one society or part of one yeah. it could be you know, its a big big question actually you know like you know...

**Researcher:** You said the right to be a member of one state.

**Khalid:** Yeah or a sole society or community or something, something to do with this.

**Researcher:** Yes, a lot to do with that, community and defining communities

**Khalid:** Yes

**Researcher:** Hmm, how would you define your community.

**Khalid:** Defining like how I describe it or ...

**Researcher:** Well, if you were to say what your community is, what would you say?

**Khalid:** Yyyyes. It depends on who you are actually, and where you live and hmm which community you know possibly we are talking about. So for example you know, hmm a community could be like you know something to do with students for example, they can like create something to defend on their rights or their yeah. Community also is possibly something to do like hmm where you live and you know where you come from you know, for me possibly, I am a Libyan or Arab, or something, so, we could hear in the UK like you know, an Arab community or a Libyan community or a French or Nigerian or whatever, African, Asian community or something. So, a community could be also something like related to your beliefs or your religion or your you know, ideology if you like. So hmm, again it's a I mean the term itself could you know, hmm it could be related to different, different issues. But hmm, my community, you know, if I can define it or describe it, possibly it's something to do with my hmm, activities, you know, where I belong to or you know...

**Researcher:** How long have you been in the UK by the way.

**Khalid:** Since 2008...7 years.

**Researcher:** How would you say your sense of identity has or has not changed by living in the UK? Now, let me try and ask the question again. I think that if people define themselves in terms of I am a man, I am French, I believe in this and that, maybe these elements may vary over time, maybe now being French for me is the most important thing in my identity, but then years from now it might be something else, if you know what I mean... Yeah...

**Researcher:** Did you feel something changed by living abroad?

**Khalid:** Mmm, not really because, again, this is something to do with my possibly with my experience, you know, just like, you know, I have been here you know, I did my MA studies some times ago you know, to tell you I came here to the UK in 2000, and I lived here for 3 years and I did my MA and, so yeah, I don't feel like you know I'm living in a different world or something, surrounded in something new for me now. But, you can say that the thing which can describe or define me, or the thing I try to keep with me all this time is my Islam, my religion. So possibly even if I go to the moon, you know, I will keep like, seeing that I'm Muslim, this is the only thing possibly I want to keep. Because it's a life issue, possibly something to do with after life, that's also what we believe. But, other things can

be changed yes. I mean, I don't mind being called British, or Libyan or Arab or European or black or white, you know, but the only thing is ... like, it's not that I'm concerned about, but you know, the only thing which I'd like to keep, which it's part of my identity, my issues, my situation, like Islam, like that's it. Apart from this possibly you know, I can like hmm, integrate, and also you different people will have different ideology and different religion they can integrate easily ... but it is the only thing that can identify me, possibly.

**Researcher:** you said in 2000 you came to the UK to do a MA, and then you went back to Libya?

**Khalid:** Yes, then I came back to the UK in 2008 to do a PhD. And it's quite good for me, living in two different societies. Diversity, like you know, I take the good experience from one society to the other one... I do like it, sometimes it's you know, it tells you you know, sometimes to identify who you are or what you do...

**Researcher:** I've a question about rights and responsibilities regarding GC. What would you say would be the rights and responsibilities of a GC?

**Khalid:** I think, the freedom of speech, I have the right to, like, say what I want, but, of course you know you have to be careful about this, terminology because you know, you are free to say what you want but not to hurt other people or interfere in their, like, private issues. I have freedom of speech, I have ... I'd like to keep my identity to be autonomous, I mean, keep myself safe, sometimes not let other people interfere, because sometimes it's nowadays it's very easy that you know some companies you know, some countries, they like break into your world, for example you know when you use the internet or your bank account or something, so some states some governments you know they sometimes interfere with you now, privacy, yes, they get information which they shouldn't have... we have also the right to keep ourselves like safe if you like...

**Researcher:** So this relates to globalisation, to global markets, global banking, hmm, on the other hand people have global rights? Rights applied globally?

**Khalid:** Yeah, yeah... I have the right to move, have the right to live everywhere I want...

**Researcher:** everywhere...

**Khalid:** yeah yeah everywhere, why not? Especially nowadays you know, the world is like a small society because of the technology and because, so why not you know, I mean I cannot understand you know, why some governments or most of the governments in the world they create barriers between people. People are the same, even though they have different ideologies, different religions, this doesn't prevent them from being integrated together, so you are from France, so why not going to Africa, why not going and live there you known, so this one is from Asia, why not going to South America for example and live there and vice versa. So, at the end of the day we are human beings, you know we have only one, hmm you know, world, we can share it, if you like, we have the right to share it. Also, we should also like you know campaign for this rights, stand for our rights, help each other, help the poor, stop the war, stop the conflicts, you know, so, yes.

**Researcher:** So when you say we should campaign, you're saying it's GC's responsibility to do that?

**Khalid:** yeah.

**Researcher:** Can we talk about skills and education? What do you think are the skills that people should have in the 21st century?

**Khalid:** I think they should have like, access to English, understand it and speak it you know... access to possibly other languages like French or Spanish, Arab... they should have access to the internet because now everything is now computerised, something to do with the computer and the internet, hmm, like, personal skills are also very important, skills about how to communicate effectively with people, the skills needed to integrate in a society. If for example you want to work in a country, in a company, in a factory, if you don't have the skill to work like, as a team, like team work and the skills to communicate with

other people, possibly this will impact negatively on the company. So, knowing or having knowledge or some backgrounds at certain skills helps you to be like you know a good communicator. To facilitate the job, to do what they ask you to do. So, yeah, hmm, possibly you need some kind of education at university, possibly like undergraduate or postgraduate studies in different skills or different subjects, this also could help you to be effective.

**Researcher:** When you came to the UK did you have expectations regarding what we've discussed? Skills, GC?

**Khalid:** yes, but. To be honest, because, you know, hmm, I studied English at home, you know, which is under graduate studies you know. And this... studying languages sometimes you know will provide you with the knowledge, with the information about how other people live, for example, if you study English literature, or English history, or French history, you grasp some kind of like first hand information about how the society... people for example behave. favourite foods, how they spend their time outside doors, so this gives me like first hand background of you know living in UK even before I came here, and a yeah... to be honest, it's something normal for me, even though I came from Libya, from the Sahara, from the desert, but, you know, it's like I armed myself with the knowledge you know, I have some information, and nothing is new for me to be honest. Possibly it is something to do with my personality because I had travelled before, I've seen different places even you know before I came to study.

**Researcher:** Where have you been?

**Khalid:** Asia, Bangkok... So yeah it's not the first time for me to integrate, to study or to interact with English or Asian or Europeans you know...

**Researcher:** Do you feel like being Libyan impedes you to be a GC? or Can someone be a GC and at the same time a citizen of Libya, France or the UK?

**Khalid:** You can say yes. but it depends on what you mean exactly you know, you can keep your identity, even if you go to the moon you can keep your identity. There's nothing wrong with this.

**Researcher:** What do you mean identity?

**Khalid:** I mean, you can hmm, like keep the way you like, for example, being who you are you know, the way you are, I think you know being Libyan, or African, or Arab or something, didn't prevent me from integrating effectively with others you know to be honest, because I do have this in my mind all the time, at the end of the day I'm a human being, and all of us we are human beings and there's no difference between us. We create this difference, we create you know like this rules, you are Arab, you are this you are that, you know, but, at the end of the day we're all human beings, there's no difference between us, it's only like politicians, governments, who create these boundaries between people, you black, you're white, you're Muslim, you're Christian, believer, non-believer or something... and hmm, I can say no, there's nothing could prevent you from being the way you want. I know that many Arabs, or Libyan who came to this society and they were very effective, they integrated very effectively with English people here, and on the other hand there are those who want or fail it, or they cannot integrate, with Europeans or with English or French or you know, because you know, they themselves they put themselves in a position or in ... I believe it's something to do with your education, your knowledge how you look at people, and possibly I said this with you before, diversity is something good! It's not that we are different, because this difference is like, it's something positive, it's not something negative, because, here for example in the North, all the time it's snowing, whereas in Africa it's very hot, so this gives you the chance to visit different places... If the whole world is the same so what's the point of like travelling to see different places? So diversity is something good. But it depends on you, how you look at the world, how you look at people you know.

**Researcher:** One last question, when you talked about skills, first thing you mentioned was speaking English. What could be the role of the English language in cosmopolitanism or GC in reference to what we've just talked about?

**Khalid:** Yeah, I mean English is a global language, it's spoken everywhere in the world. I mean, it's necessary, it's a must for especially like, international students. To have like English language, or French, because this is something to do with colonialism, with the past or something. But you know, let us keep ourselves from politicians something. English is spoken everywhere in the world, so it's important to be capable to speak in the language or understanding it or writing it, because most of the companies, they interact in English, so mastering this language is something important, it possibly gives you the chance to find a job, to get what you want...

**Researcher:** Did speaking English and study here change the way you look at your own country?

**Khalid:** It's not the language, it's not English ... to some extent you can say yes, yes, because, when you study a language, you be part of it, to some extent, also you understand the culture, if you understand the culture this will possibly also give you more knowledge, like, gives you some packing you know, to behave in a different way I mean, it is something to do with education, the more learn, the better for you, it's not only about English or a specific language, or specific skills or something but, when you learn something, this will impact effectively, the more you learn the better for you. if you learn different skills that means you have the ability to do different skills, so it's something to do with education, it's something beneficent. Its impact will reflect on you.

**Researcher:** Did you feel learning English or mastering English make you more of a GC? Or make you being detached from being Libyan to some extent? Did it change your identity?

**Khalid:** No no no no no no no ... It empowered me. When you learn another language that means you know, you have more knowledge. More access to different, open the windows to different cultures, so it empowers you. Makes you feel that you are part of this society, makes you feel like you know, yeah, I can do it. Helps you find a job, be an effective member of the society, no matter..., I'm talking about society as one world. No matter as a Libyan or whatever. So I believe in integration, in some kind of globalisation, even if we are different, come from different background, but this world can contain all of us and make one global society, and make a very successful one, once we believe that you know yes, we can.

## Interview 2 – Robert 22/04/2015

**Researcher:** So you said you were studying contemporary business issues?

**Robert:** My major is business and finance. Contemporary business issues is one of the course that I'm study.

**Researcher:** Can you tell me more about this course? What it is about?

**Robert:** It's about business issues such as in around the world. Such as the oil price and the China rising, and hmm and the quantitative easing of the EU and the monetary policy with China and hmm the...

**Researcher:** So it's a lot about globalisation?

**Robert:** yeah

**Researcher:** So what do you think of the... what would you say are the main issues for humanity?

**Robert:** For humans? Wow it's a big question...

**Researcher:** I know it's a big question.

**Robert:** The environment is a really big question for the human, and the war, I think if the country [??] human need to, the country need to keep peace, but hmm some countries, about the environment, some countries just pay attention to development, not pay attention to the environment, just like China.

**Researcher:** My research is about GC.

**Robert:** Does it mean the relationship with people from different countries?

**Researcher:** The thing is you see, there are many different definitions of GC, nobody really knows what it is, it can be a lot of things. The purpose of my research is to find out what international students think it could be or should be. So if you hear the word GC what do you think of?

**Robert:** I think it's just the relationship with people from different countries. Maybe is friendly and maybe hmm have some [??] with each other.

[Blank]

**Researcher:** So do you think somebody can be a French citizen, or a Chinese citizen and at the same time a global citizen?

**Robert:** Hmm, GC I don't think I understand what is a global citizen?

**Researcher:** Some people call it a world citizen...

**Robert:** World citizen... I think if they come from China they are Chinese citizen, if they come from the USA they are American citizen and, world citizen, does this mean for example they're people from China and they do something in the USA, and they also do something in the UK, does it mean...?

**Researcher:** What it means most of the time, because people disagree about what it is, but they sort of agree on, hmm, if you're a Chinese citizen or an English citizen or an American citizen or whatever, we all share something in common which is humanity. Regardless of what country we're from, we have something strong that bounds us together.

**Robert:** Ah... Mmm. So it means people from different countries to .... hmm...

**Researcher:** What it means according to some people is that I'm French, you're Chinese but it doesn't matter, we're both Human Beings first.

**Robert:** Oh yeah. So we try and talk to each other...

**Researcher:** Yeah we can... So do you think that addressing the issues of humanity, environment, violence, do you think GC can do something, or have to do something, must do something.

**Robert:** GC, I think if one country want to do some project with another country they need GC to communicate with each other and do the project successfully. Mmm, and is developing globalisation, I think the global citizen, the number of GC maybe is increasing.

**Researcher:** So, how would you define a GC, what would be his qualities, his skills? Can you imagine?

**Robert:** Hmm, if let me to define GC maybe it's just like global, hmm, international students is kind of GC.

**Researcher:** Why? What makes them GC?

**Robert:** Because they come from different countries, and they study in different countries and they can communicate with each other. It'd a global relation communication. I think international students is belong to the GC, and maybe some people from hmm, from..., for example, a Chinese people work in the UK, and this people is also a global citizen, because they can take their methods, their ideas from China, and their culture from China into the UK, so I think this kind of people is also belong to a the GC.

**Researcher:** Ok, just to make sure I understand, people who have immigrated and work here, for example they have a job, they have a shop, so they belong to the British community, but they've brought with them their culture, their language

**Robert:** Yeah

**Researcher:** Ok. And, you talked about international students being GC, I think it's very interesting, because I would like to know if you think there are things we must learn to become GC, or to become more GC, or maybe better GC? Are there things we need to learn to become global citizen?

**Robert:** Yeah of course, because hmm, if international students cannot say, if they want to communicate with each other they need language, they need the same language to communicate with each other, if their language is very poor they cannot communicate well, so if they want to be a good global citizen they need to practice their language. As for me I need to practice language.

**Researcher:** You're doing fine. So language, what else?

**Robert:** And culture maybe. Hmm, culture is a really big problem, hmm...

**Researcher:** What do you mean?

**Robert:** Hmm, in China, hmm, if I say you are beautiful today, in China they will say: No, I'm not beautiful you are beautiful, you are more beautiful. But in Britain I think if you say you are beautiful today, and they will say: Thank you! Ha-ha!

**Researcher:** Yes

**Robert:** It's really different, about culture, and hmm, so we need to learn other people's culture, how they interact, Because culture gap can make two people to communicate not very easy...

**Researcher:** I would like to talk again about, you mentioned environment and violence. Well you said war, ...

**Robert:** Yeah...

**Researcher:** and hmm, what do you think about inequalities? Some people are rich, some people are poor. How can being a GC ... Can GC do something about that?

**Robert:** About that. Let me see...They can do so many things for this. It's belong to, it's a problem for the government.

**Researcher:** Well we've been talking about responsibilities, but maybe we could talk about rights. Do you think GC have rights or should have rights? And what sort of rights?

**Robert:** They should have rights to go to different countries easily. So they can take, hmm, they can take their culture and their products and their methods to different countries to help other countries to become better. Maybe this can help the poor people in the countries to become rich.

**Researcher:** Before you came to the UK, what skills did you expect to improve?

**Robert:** Language!

**Researcher:** Only this?

**Robert:** Hmm, and my major. I need to learn more things about my major in order to find a good job in the future. It will help me get a good job.

**Researcher:** What do you think are the main benefits of knowing English, being able to communicate in English? For you as a person.

**Robert:** I think it's very important for people to, to use English. If they can speak English, they can communicate with people from other countries because there're so many people in different countries that they can speak English. It's a basic ability for a GC I think.

**Researcher:** How long have you been in the UK now?

**Robert:** 10 months

**Researcher:** Do you look differently at your country? Do you see being Chinese or so you see China differently?

**Robert:** Mmm, yes maybe. I think maybe before I come to the UK I think people in Taiwan they, Chinese people think Taiwan is belong to China, but when I come to the UK, I know some people from Taiwan and from different countries, they don't think Taiwan is belong to China. So, I think it's really interesting.

**Researcher:** Yes, it is interesting.

**Robert:** Yeah...

**Researcher:** And why do you think that is? What's the reason for that?

**Robert:** If you are Chinese, when some people ask you where are you from, they will say I come from China, yeah, whatever you are come from different province, bit if you ask people from Taiwan and they will tell you they're from Taiwan, not China. And I told them, Taiwan is a part of China, but they don't think so...

**Researcher:** And hmm, has your view on this changed? Well you said you find it interesting or bizarre or, you said interesting, but do you feel differently about this now?

**Robert:** differently?

**Researcher:** Yeah...

**Robert:** I think, no I think Taiwan is, maybe it's a country [laughs], but I know Chinese people don't want to hmm, say that. But I think is truth. Taiwan is just like a country

**Researcher:** Ok...Do you think being Chinese stops you from being a GC? Or maybe it helps you?

**Robert:** I think it helps me. Because hmm, China starts to opening outside from 1978, and after that China start to communicate more with different countries, and they can let their students, their young men to go to other countries to study, learn something interesting, something new, so I think it helps me, and China develop very quickly, and then my parents can earn enough money to make me to go abroad to study. I think it helps.

### Interview 3 – Mohamed 29/04/2015

**Researcher:** Where are you from Mohamed?

**Mohamed:** I am from Saudi Arabia.

**Researcher:** What exactly are you studying here right now?

**Mohamed:** Now I study language English, after that I will study physics subject... nano-technology, MA.

**Researcher:** You have done a BA in Saudi Arabia?

**Mohamed:** Yes, in general physics

**Researcher:** My research is about globalisation, global issues, and these sort of things. And my first question will be, in your subject, what do you think you need to learn in relation to globalisation. Are there links between your subject and the world, and globalisation?

**Mohamed:** My special subject I will study is nanotechnology. Nanotechnology is a new subject about me because at earliest stage I took little information about nanotechnology but in MA I will take more information about it. I will take this information for my home and for my students there, because I'm a teacher in technical college in Saudi Arabia.

**Researcher:** How has Saudi Arabia changed with Globalisation?

**Mohamed:** Now has more change than past. Because because government sent more student to abroad for study different subject like science and education and medicine. You know, big country in education and science like UK and USA this country have high effect on all subject. and government want to their student get more and give this information to home. Now change, big change than past.

**Researcher:** Are there a lot of foreigners in Saudi Arabia?

**Mohamed:** Yes, India, from Pakistan, from UK and USA, especially in big companies. Indian people work in the street something, not easy work and low wages. and we have big universities about language Arabic. university Islamic.

**Researcher:** What do you think is important to learn to live in the world now? you say the government is sending more and more people from your country abroad... To learn what?

**Mohamed:** in the start, government send their student to anywhere in the world, UK, USA, Australia, India... For any subject. but after maybe 7 years this figure decrease because maybe budget is very high and now they choose just in work and specials. like science, like education maybe decrease now. change the government policy.

**Researcher:** What are you expecting to learn here, apart from your subject?

**Mohamed:** I want to go to labs, and I want, I wish to see nanotechnology...

**Researcher:** I'm interested to know what learning in another environment, speaking another language probably working with people from China, Africa, Europe, what you can learn from that?

**Mohamed:** I can learn hmm, many cultures. How people life in china, I will take this information from Chinese people here, and how relationships between them and we or me, I can send some information about me to them, about my culture, religion, like this. Yes really really important.

**Researcher:** Why?

**Mohamed:** because in past few of student go out my country but now lots of student study abroad and this good ways for give them information about you, and the world, and know about your culture and religion, to what you do, and you can give them some message and take from them.

**Researcher:** I'd like to talk about the English language now. How do you feel about studying in English, communicating in English all the time?



**Mohamed:** Learn English sometime I feel I'm in the middle, sometime I feel it's really bad, I need too much...

**Researcher:** What do you think are the big problems of the world?

**Mohamed:** I not sure about this but, war... this not good for all, especially in the middle east.

**Researcher:** Do you think people knowing more about other cultures could make a difference?

**Mohamed:** Because the first cause, the religion. Yes. Some religion, people not understand what it mean, exactly what it mean, some people understand little what it mean. If the people understand exactly what it mean religion, they're Islamic or Christian or Judaic, exactly what it mean, they think all people like the religion. Because all religion of sky, of god.

**Researcher:** When you say people don't understand exactly what it means, maybe people have different understandings...

**Mohamed:** Maybe, maybe, but in the end, not understand exactly.

**Researcher:** Are you saying maybe, some people don't understand what it means for other people?

**Mohamed:** Maybe, if I good in English I will talk more but hmm...

**Researcher:** Have you heard the word global citizen before? As you've read, my research is about global citizenship.

**Mohamed:** Citizenship? What it means? Global I know.

**Researcher:** I'm a French citizen...

**Mohamed:** Yeah yeah yeah...

**Researcher:** People use this word more and more especially in universities... Do you think it's possible?

**Mohamed:** I think we can but nor for all... because the culture is different between the people, Indian people have special culture, and European community have another different, and Arabic.... maybe this possible in that community like Arabic together, if you mix all Arabic countries together, like Saudi Arabia, like Egypt, etc., ok? Not a problem because the culture same, and European community like now, I think EU community now together, you don't need a visa, and the money, euro for all... Big community I think we can, global citizen but, with all the world, maybe difficult...

**Researcher:** Because you see some people say that, you're Arabic, you're Saudi Arabia, I'm white, European, French or whatever, but first and foremost we're Human Beings. Before I'm French, I'm a Human Being, before you're Saudi, you're a Human Being. So some people say that on this basis, we should all feel connected and we should first of all be Human Beings, and then maybe some speak this language, some speak that language...

**Mohamed:** Yes, again I agree with you...

**Researcher:** I'm not saying that's what I think but this is the subject I'm trying to understand.

**Mohamed:** Yes. This is a fact. All of us, women... yeah but after maybe wars, all countries are divided, closed, but with internet now, with the social media we can connect together but some things maybe in future change.

**Researcher:** You said that maybe big communities could share citizenship or be united in some way... but you see in my country there are 60 million people and there are about 6 million Arabic people... And most of them are Muslim, not all of them, they're from Algeria .... So I'm thinking of my country which is multicultural... so why should we be separated after all?

**Mohamed:** You're right, yes in my country also we have foreign people for more than 20 years 30 years, we have like French people and Arabic people together, and another religion, we have many people different religion and different language... this word, GC, in

fact now, it's a fact, you can, like in France, in Saudi Arabia, together many people and many culture and many religion, together in one country, no problem.

**Researcher:** And what would be the benefit of believing we are GC rather than I'm French, you're Saudi and so on... Why would it be a good thing to think we are GC?

**Mohamed:** I think there are 2 reasons about the problem. First about the .... Second I think about economic. Because if you compare between two countries like Saudi Arabia and poor country, it's very different, this rich country and this poor. If I treat this people like my citizen people it is not fair. this problem if I delete this border it's not balance income and economic... and first one I think about government politics. Some people would invest [??] how I receive these people from poor country to our country. I think position with government and economic. Two reasons.

**Researcher:** You're right, a lot of people say that GC could mean that there is a global government, like one government for the whole planet and that could be scary or, a lot of people say that would not be a good thing.

**Mohamed:** And who first one or high...oppose. it's problem

**Researcher:** But also there are people who say that never mind governments, we don't need a global government to be GC. That we have to feel we are united even though our governments are not.

**Mohamed:** I think just imagine not fact. because difficult.

**Researcher:** Ok this is not a fact, but some say we should feel that way to be more connected, to help each other, to solve problems of the planet, for example the environment, global poverty, like we should work together, help each other, and feel that we are one community. And the divisions between the community like borders, governments, they are not relevant...

**Mohamed:** Yeah, it's good idea but, when we do that I think we have more more problems. Help each other, live together and one community is good. but when you want to be fact I think you have more problems with it.

**Researcher:** But for some people it is a fact already, for example, Green peace, they consider themselves GC...

**Mohamed:** It's correct but I don't know exactly in the future what will happen but GC we can see it with some ways like internet like mobile phones, travel, but like my talk before, 2 reasons this problem: government and economy. This sort of things is possible, we can work together if some country help another country...

**Researcher:** I think maybe it's not about helping, it's just working together...

**Mohamed:** But you know, in fact, it's not that big country help another country but not free, you know. I mean if I help another country I will take some benefits, any benefit, it's because the government is not good with GC, just education talk that, but in fact government, anyone has problems, but people maybe like it...

**Researcher:** But you know some people who defend this idea of GC will say hell with the government, the government are not doing the right thing, we are going to do the right thing. No matter what the government does, we unite, and decide to do things together like fight for human rights, fight for the environment, or, change some things...

**Mohamed:** Ok but, we need some papers some, if you talk about just thinking, it's already like your think, because you think it's good.... I agree with another people, but in fact if I will together... we need some papers passports, I mean borders not cancelled.

## Interview 4 – Valerie 7/5/15

**Researcher:** So remind me what you major is.

**Valerie:** Business management

**Researcher:** And my first question will be about your course. Are there tasks or activities or things that address globalisation? International matters...

**Valerie:** Mmmmmmmmm, sorry, I didn't get that.

**Researcher:** So you study business

**Valerie:** Yeah

**Researcher:** In your studies, are there issues about the world, globalisation, international, ...

**Valerie:** No, I don't think so.

**Researcher:** No, not at all?

**Valerie:** I don't think have any issues.

**Researcher:** But when you study business things, I don't know much about business, but I suppose you study how business can be run in different countries at the same time maybe, or with people with different nationalities...

**Valerie:** With people? No I don't think have any issues, I think the biggest problem is from the, you know, language skill.

**Researcher:** No I don't mean problems for you I mean problems of the world

**Valerie:** Of the world?

**Researcher:** Yeah, there's lots of problem in the world [laughs]

**Valerie:** Oh yeah, like I study contemporary business issues. So yeah, there have lots of business issues around the world like, oil price falling down and like cannabis legalisation in America, yeah like this kind of issue [laughs] and hmm, yeah I think that's all.

**Researcher:** Ok, so what would be from this perspective, from what your study, the biggest problems in the world in the 21st century?

**Valerie:** I think it's like deflation in Europe and hmm, China's economy slowing down, growth slowing down, and I think that cannabis thing, cannabis legalisation in America, still you know like become very, I think that it will become like some issue, and hmm, world economy something, but, I don't really know about this, I just you know, listen to some radio, on news, but in my course I didn't receive any, we didn't discuss about any issues, and this research is you need to do and find out by yourself, but I don't think it's issue, just you know like developing, yeah.

**Researcher:** So you've been in the UK for what? One year?

**Valerie:** Yeah, almost one year.

**Researcher:** What are the most important things that you've learnt and that would make you improve this hmm, communication with other culture, with people from other cultures?

**Valerie:** Yeah, I think it's like what I'm studying like I did my English course and to improve my language skill and get out to communicate with people like British or something. I had a British boyfriend but we broke up now, and I can't understand you know like, culture things is really like an issue for people to communicate, like, we have different value, like these things, value about society, government and money. I think it's all these things from culture, this issue from the culture and we don't have... we can't persuade each other to accept your idea, yeah, he can't accept my idea. I still make lots of British friends, they just have like, not same, very similar thinking and value about you know government, and news, and money, these kind of things. And most of my British friends they hate wealth, they think it's really bad.

**Researcher:** Wealth, like lots of money?

**Valerie:** Yeah they hate rich people. I don't know why. Mmm, but they just you know think, rich people they can do anything to help this society and, they think the government should average the money to help poor people, but you know, rich people become more rich and poor people become you know more poor. They really hate, you know like, and most of my friends they don't like government something, and they want freedom. I just don't care about this, why should I care. I told them I think freedom is not like hmm, you know, your government give you like so many limitations and they just want to control you, I think every group need have leader, but I can't understand, I think the freedom you give to yourself, not somebody else give to you, it's just you know like, mmm, can't understand me can't understand my thinking. I think the background, you know like, where you're from, culture things, can cause so many issues, with communicate ways, from people from different country and background. I think value things are important and hmm, maybe most of my British friends, they are not from a middle class or like rich family.

**Researcher:** They're from lower social class?

**Valerie:** Yeah, I think so.

**Researcher:** And yourself, so you consider yourself middle class, upper class?

**Valerie:** I think I'm from middle class in China. But, I don't think wealth can cause so many problems. and, they think it's unfair, but I think every people they have money, they should go to make money, do their business, they still you know take responsibility, they still have you know contribute to the society, but I don't think you should have that attitude, to hate wealth, when you see some people who drive a nice car, you know, go crazy and you know like, be unhappy...

**Researcher:** So they say that rich people don't contribute enough...

**Valerie:** I think that's their thinking, but you know just like my family, from the middle class, we're not that rich but we still pay tax and we're still you now like hmm, my father really want to help some people, like students can't afford the money to go to school, and some old people, and build up some people house, I think they still have some thinking you know, like go to help poor people, but if you like, just like my ex boyfriend: I just want to stick in here, I don't want to, you now, make money I don't want to become rich, I don't want to do anything to, you know like, get money... I think that's not right. They think poor, is cool thing. I just can't get that. I don't know why.

**Researcher:** And they understand the way you think?

**Valerie:** I think they understand but you know they can't accept. Yeah, they try to persuade me, and try to tell me you know like, tell me how bad of the wealth, and how many bad things they did, and they like, escape the tax, and avoid the tax, and spend a lot of money for handbags and the cars and ... They use money to enjoy the life, it's not like help poor people, but I don't know why they have to, I don't think they have to help poor people, because money, I think they really try so hard to make money, [???], and to become rich, it's not like get born and rich, it's not like that. but I can understand them, they can understand me, but we can't accept if we talk about news, we talk about like value things like money, wealth, these things we're fine, we can have cool communication, but when we talk about this we have big arguments.

**Researcher:** And I suppose you have tried to see things with their eyes?

**Valerie:** I tried, really I tried. like, hmm, stand their side and look about these things, and I really learned something like new things, you know like, Hong Kong occupy centre, yeah that things happened, and I get angry really...

**Researcher:** Really?

**Valerie:** Yeah, because I'm Chinese. I still have some feelings. I get angry I don't know why. HongKongese tries to do that against the government and when I heard this news I really get angry like my friends you know, like British friends they say, they told me 'it's not like news will tell you everything you want to know, it's news tell you everything they want

you to know'. So, you need to have questions about this you know. Ask questions and do more research. I learned about this, I think that's right.

**Researcher:** I'm sorry, who said that?

**Valerie:** My friends, they're British. So I think it's right they changed my mind, and the question about the news and you need ... don't believe everything the news tell you. and you need believe yourself and do more research.

**Researcher:** Ok, what do you think it would take to see things through their eyes? to make you understand them better? Or them to understand you better?

**Valerie:** Hmm, I dunno. I think I can understand them because like my family... when I was born, we're in the middle class, and when I was born my family really poor. I had 10 years staying in the country side staying with my grandpa and grandma and my parents go to work and do their business, really busy. But I still can't understand their thinking you know like, they hate wealth because they think it's unfair because if you're rich you can easy to make money like, If I have billions and billions I just put in the bank I still can make money I still can buy what I want. But, if you're poor it's really hard to make money. I think this is unfair I think this is what they think. and they still think rich people need help the poor people. I think that's right, because you know I have this thinking. If one day I can become rich .... help poor people and do something to contribute this society. This is my thinking, this also is a reason why I come to here study and get my qualification, find a job, open my horizon, this kind of things...

**Researcher:** What do you mean by 'open your horizon'?

**Valerie:** Hmm, like if you always stay in China, like, before I come to here, hmm, we think UK is very dangerous place, why? because we heard some news it's like 'some international students died' and some people killed a girl when they do their master or do their degree something, yeah. We think that's dangerous but when I come to here, I think it's really safe, yeah, it's better than China, people really polite, and the street really clean, and you can have just my views and my opinions, I change my opinions and my ideas and I have met some new friends, they have different thinking and we were communicate... I really changed my mind. I really think they're right, and like, they hate wealth, and I totally understand, and before I came here I just think every British they're really rich, yeah this is development country so they have really good welfare and they don't need worry about you know like cancer something, they can make money easily, because the minimum wages like 6.5 or 7 pounds that's a lot of money! Really it's impossible in China because in China people have really low wages. So, I would think all the British are really rich. Now I come here, and I find it's not right. And every country will have different class and they have different thinking about wealth, and hmm, not everybody is rich and like, family things, most of my British friends, they didn't get financial support from their family when they do their degree. But it's different in China, we get financial support from our family. My parents told me, you just need to concentrate on your course and finish you study and come back, that's all. I don't need to worry anything about money. But they always worry about these things. So, I can understand more culture things, and I also can understand how to understand people, we have different backgrounds...

**Researcher:** Interesting...

**Valerie:** Yeah

**Researcher:** Hmm, did you have expectations before you came here, did you think oh I'm going to learn this, I'm going to learn that, I'm going to improve my English...

**Valerie:** Yes

**Researcher:** What were these expectations? And did you learn other things? Things you didn't expect to learn?

**Valerie:** Actually, I think this is my plan, come here to finish my English course and do my major, [???]...tutors have standards to correct your essay [???...???...], I did a lot of reports

and essays and presentations, I found out it's not right, tutors still have their own judgments, I just got my feed back about creative management, but I get really low marks and my friends from the same class we get really low marks and we don't know why. Because all our points are from the tutor and the argument points from the tutor and we still told him about our own thinking. He said if you write down this it will become better, and when I print out my essay and give my tutor have a look they say it's so far so good and I still ask him do i need something else to improve they say no, I think it's fine, it's really good. but it's a different tutor who gives the marks and the teacher write down the comments say 'your point is wrong', and all your essay is wrong.

**Researcher:** Do you think there's a communication problem?

**Valerie:** I don't think so. Because we record everything and we write down everything and it's not like I give some points to the tutor to have a look, I gave him my hole essay, and he also correct my reference, so this is so far so good! I just you know like feel disappointed. Maybe tomorrow I will find my tutor and ask about this... Because I think this is personal judgment, really. Can I have a look at the standards, yeah...

**Researcher:** But you know there should be more than one person correcting it.

**Valerie:** But my whole class, my friends their marks from the same teacher, we got really low marks but we don't know why, really. It's really difficult to find tutor. They have some time, but it's really short. One week have two hours time but you have lots of students. you need to queue for that and make appointments something, really hard. You can send an email and ask, but it's not suitable for me, I can't explain very clearly, can't get the information I really want. I don't think I misunderstand about this course and the points that tutor told me. ...

**Researcher:** Did you get to work with a lot of people from different countries?

**Valerie:** Yeah

**Researcher:** What countries?

**Valerie:** Like, I don't really know, like Brazil, and lots of Brazilians, and like Africa something...

**Researcher:** Did you do some group work with them?

**Valerie:** Yeah. We did two presentations with Africa girl, she is from Africa. I think it's good, and we can understand each other and hmm, but, she always late! [laughs]

**Researcher:** Do you think that's cultural as well?

**Valerie:** I don't know but you know we didn't get angry or something we just, ok, it's fine we can wait. We had 10 times meeting in the library, every-time like we said 4 o'clock, she will come like 4:30 or sometimes like 7 p.m., she will come like 8. But it's fine, we're friendly [laughs]

**Researcher:** And how did it go communication wise?

**Valerie:** I think it's pretty good, don't have misunderstanding and she can speak really good English and if we can't understand she will explain and hmm, if we don't understand we won't pretend we understand, we would say 'what do you mean' you know... She will explain to us, so it's really good...

**Researcher:** Do you think getting used to working with people from all over the world will be helpful for maybe you career or...

**Valerie:** Yyyyes, I think so. I never you know like mingle with Koreans [laughs] you know, we like make groups with local people, native speakers, because, ... really helpful, they're still really happy to help us, they're really friendly...

**Researcher:** What do you think are the most important things to learn to prepare for your life, I say life because I don't want to say just your career. Although career is important but you know life is not just your career...

**Valerie:** Hmm, as for me I think... get married [laughs]

**Researcher:** I said learn...

b: This is learn! You know like, how to you know like make funny something, and I think now you should learn how to be polite to people and how to respect to people, and if you're in a group, I won't speak Chinese with my friends, I will always speak English, I think that's respect, and respect everyone, and ... I think this is the most important thing, but, let me think about what I should learn, I should learn about...

**Researcher:** The reason I'm asking is because now people say that the world is changing rapidly, that people travel more, people migrate, they change countries to find work, and more and more we'll have to work with people who come from other cultures. So I believe an important thing to learn is to work with people from Africa, from Brazil, from China....

**Valerie:** I think another background, another culture thing, like, if I work with a girl who is French or something, I don't really know about French culture, but if I really want to make group with him, we should work in a team, I think understand their culture is the most important thing, and what they care, what they like what they dislike, and use a good way to communicate, I think it's very important, it's like, hmm, maybe you know Chinese is very sensitive, like people from Africa they're really sensitive, I think this topic is really sensitive, we have colour skin, this is really sensitive... So I understand culture things is really important. Respect is really important, care about people's feeling, don't say rude things, like Tai, she's from Africa, she's really sensitive... she's unhappy when we speak Chinese

**Researcher:** Now that you've been here almost a year, do you see your own country differently?

**Valerie:** Yeah, we really want to live in our news

**Researcher:** In our news?

**Valerie:** Yes, just like the news, you know? we heard like, it's really good, Chinese people have a really good life, but, I think that's not true. Still have so many people in China still can't afford education fees, and still have millions people they don't have enough food, and they don't have properties, and they can't even get clean water. But in Chinese news it's really good, everything you know goes so well, but it's not true. We always say I really want to live in news, not in real life. This has changed and also, Hong Kong news, like, these things, occupy centre, the news always misleading people, this is my change, I change my minds bout news... Everything you need critical thinking and hmm, you can't believe everything the news tell you and, you need to think by yourself it's really important. This is what I learned.

**Researcher:** What do you think can be done about those million people in China who are still in poverty? Who's to do anything? Is it the government, is it the other countries, is it the people of China? What can be done?

**Valerie:** I think in China they really need government help, I just can't get that, maybe I'm not study finance something I can't understand China spend a lot of money to build up so many buildings but can't they build properties for poor people? Really it's really sad, they don't even have pens to write and don't have books. And so where is that from free education? Chinese government said we have 9 years for education, primary school, high school, secondary school it's all free but it's not. Still have lots of people can't afford, lots of children they want to study because they think in China you must get qualification and you can change your life, you can get out of the countryside. you don't need to be farmer, you can change your life if you study. But How can this dream come true? Because they can't even afford the education fee. So every time I think about this I feel bad because rich people they don't need to work really hard to get money and their children can go to really good school and still have million children can't go to school. They don't have a chance to change their life. I think government should care about these things, to do something to help them. Our power, like my parent, they really want to help some poor students, like my father like now, raised money to help students to get to university. We are not powerful, I think government is powerful, they have lots of money

**Researcher:** But isn't the government all the people together? Like you said your parents would like to help, maybe they can help a little, but they're not powerful. But millions of people together like your parents they become very powerful...

**Valerie:** Yeah but you know [laughs] some people they're just selfish. But everybody needs to take responsibility for this society, we need to advertise for this [does she mean campaign?] No matter your rich or poor. You should have, you know, understand why is poor understand why is rich understand each other. Government should organise redistribution.

**Researcher:** Do you think people have responsibility for the whole world?

**Valerie:** Yeah maybe but as for me I just have responsibility for my country [laughs] because maybe I'm not that tolerant, I'm not that powerful. I think I just do myself, I just do what I think is good, I think this is contribution to society, contribution to this whole world. I'm a student, I just you know like be a good student and do my MA and just you know maybe I can stay here and do some contribution like research, maybe I can do but I have this thinking, if I do my business and make money I'll have so many employees, this is contribution! Just do what you think is good but you need know what is really good, don't be selfish. you need find a good way to help people it's not like just give some money to them, I think it's not a good way. Help the job, help students this is contribution to the world. Be a good person be a good human being and don't waste the food, that's really important [laughs].



## Interview 5 – Marco 27/05/2015

**Researcher:** So remind me what you're studying at DMU.

**Marco:** A Master's Course for pharmacy, the name is quality by design.

**Researcher:** Are there modules or activities in your course that relate to globalisation?

**Marco:** Hmm, I don't think so...

**Researcher:** Are there things that link to issues about the world changing?

**Marco:** Yeah, but the course is to change the industry, the pharmaceutical industry in the world, so maybe this is a relation, cause the idea is to avoid wasting material so we can improve the efficiency of the industry and do not cause any damage to the world, like in environmental terms.

**Researcher:** What are the main issues in Pharmacy? What is the purpose of pharmacy?

**Marco:** To develop medicines to help, to cure diseases... a doctor will give a diagnosis....

**Researcher:** Do you have anything in this course that relates to health issues worldwide? Access to health maybe?

**Marco:** Well, I wouldn't say there is a direct relationship, but if we can improve the efficiency we will decrease the price of medicine, and we can also work with medicines that aren't being used because they have problems with safety, so we can improve the use of these medicines, and then we would be able to work with cheaper drugs, and this would be a benefit. But it's not a direct relationship.

**Researcher:** How many people are there on your course?

**Marco:** About 25

**Researcher:** Where are they from, roughly?

**Marco:** Hmm, it's a very multicultural course, we have some British, we have people from Africa, Nigeria and other countries, Brazil, some people from other parts of Europe, other than UK, and we have some British who are the sons and daughters of parents that are not English, they have a different background, it's very mixed

**Researcher:** How are you feeling in this group?

**Marco:** Ok... It's interesting to see different patterns of behaviour, like you can see the Chinese they're really shy, they don't talk too much but they really do their task at the final limit, and other guys they don't really care about it. And you can see some differences between cultures, I think.

**Researcher:** Did you have a lot of group work?

**Marco:** Yes

**Researcher:** Were they beneficial?

**Marco:** I think so. That's the thing, we can see differences in education also. For example, we have two different courses for pharmacy. One that focuses on industrial things and this type of things and other there is for taking care of people. In Brazil we just have one course. So we basically need to know everything, so there is a difference because they really know the subject and we have broad view but we're not that specialised. I can't tell you about the Chinese because I've never been in a group with them, but English, people who studied here, they have a different perspective because they're really more specialised, so I guy that studied pharmaceutical science will really know about industry and how to make a medicine, but basically he doesn't know about how medicine interacts with people, how it is processed in the body, he doesn't really know about side effects, and it's a really important thing to know about. And we know everything but we don't know everything in detail like they know.

**Researcher:** And I suppose people come from what they know already about the subject, you mentioned their education, so I suppose they come with, hmm, issues related to pharmacy that are peculiar to their country of origin. And how does that play out in the course?

**Marco:** This is an interesting point. For example, in Brazil, we have a lot of federal university, some research they're conducted by the government, and we study a lot neglected diseases that they're not part of European world, so when we have a group discussion, we think different. Because the problem with neglected diseases, that you need to solve with a medicine, they're different from common diseases like diabetes or cardiovascular problems that you have all over the world, and they're problems related with wealthy nations. Because in poor nations you don't have this type of problems. For example, gout is related to eating too much, in poor countries you really don't have this type of thing. So, the challenges for pharmacists to help on diseases they are different. So, for quality by design, we need to think about disease and what we want to treat, what we want to achieve, what is our goal? And when you're doing a group work, this is a main thing, to decide what we are going to do, it's quite different because we have different perspectives. In Brazil for example we always think about things related to neglected diseases, that our common medicines, drug that are useful for us. And they are thinking of drugs that are useful for them, and this really influenced the process, it's a problem. That's why sometimes the lecturer gives an example. You will talk about this medicine only... So we don't have this problem discussing which one we'll pick.

**Researcher:** What have you learned from this multicultural thing? Have you started to reflect on your own learning and how you see things differently or how you might see things differently?

**Marco:** Relating to learning I would say that here, people read more alone, you know, as in Brazil have a lot of lecturers. We spend most of our university time in lectures, we really don't have time to study alone, here they have this cultural thing to study alone and to do a lot of course work, here we don't have exams, in Brazil it would be like impossible, we need to have exams. In Brazil we have more exams than course work, really more. Here, they have a lot of course work. For assignments you think and you research, you need to think about your subject, you need to write your own conclusions about it so I think you learn more and better than test. This is a really important difference for me.

**Researcher:** Before you came to the UK, did you have any expectations about what you were going to learn in terms of what you need, hmm, and in relation to globalisation... Let me try again. I believe the world is changing, there are things we need to learn and they might be different from the things that people learned 30 years ago. What were your expectations when you came here and how this is going to help you for your life?

**Marco:** Ok... What really I've learned here ... some people here they really work hard, they want to do the best they can do. Like from what I've heard it's a lot like the US. they really are... they just stop when they have the maximum. In Brazil you don't have that culture. We're used to do the sufficient, not the maximum. So this is something that I wasn't expecting that much but that made a difference in everything, in my product, in lectures, in group work.... So this is something I wasn't expecting. Another thing that I wasn't expecting, is the time that you spend in lectures. I didn't know that here we don't have so many lectures, so this was a shock, something I wasn't expecting. In what I really was expecting, is this view of corporation view, you see pharmacy through the eyes of industry, in Brazil we don't have this approach, we really focus on health, because like I told you, in Brazil we focus on health, in the UK both health and industry, so this is something I was expecting, because I know that here they have both approaches and they try to make pharmacy for industry also.

**Researcher:** Something you were expecting...

**Marco:** Yeah

**Researcher:** And hmm, in general, what do you think people need to learn at university? Given the way the world is changing, globalisation...

**Marco:** Hmm, in terms of academic understanding, I think that what we really need to learn in university is how to read better. For example, when you arrive to university, in my view, you know how to read in terms of I understand what is written, but at the end of university, I need to understand what is written, the context behind, the conclusions I can draw through that thing. So I think uni really needs to develop reading, to read better, in academic terms. I think you need to be independent, to seek your own knowledge, to go, to pursue what you want, the knowledge you will need to do. You can't expect that the lecturer will deliver everything for you. So I think this is something that IS learn because they have this cultural shock in terms of uni, and we need to go for it and learn alone, and we have this approach of living alone and taking care of ourselves without our parents, this is something interesting actually, because here they have this culture that when you have 18 years old, 19 years old, when you go to uni you basically live alone, you don't live with your parents and a lot of the [???]. So in Brazil we don't have this culture. Because we stay all the time at uni, we stay at our parents' home until we finish uni, and some more time [???] established in some work. So this is something really different, because they are more independent here. Because I think all things are related. they need to be more independent in life, and because of that, not because of that but, together, they need to be more independent in their own study, learning. I think that was confusing [laughs]...

**Researcher:** I'm interested in what you said about reading. You say we need to understand more about the context, hmm, when you say that, what I understand is, hmm, what is written on the paper could mean different things...

**Marco:** Well, I think if I give an example... Let's say I'm working on a project right now. And I need to find specific information about technique, ok? For example, I have a molecule and I need to find a specific number that is related to this technique. A common mistake that freshmen would do is like, they would look for the technique and he would find any number and he would think that this number is related to that molecule. Well his just reading that, ha ok, this number is the response but he didn't ... not just understand what is written but asking some questions...

**Researcher:** Being critical...

**Marco:** Yep. But that thing... just read, like read a book, and just accept that, ok, this is true, I believe that I understood, I believe that's fine. But you need to read and question and think about what this guy is talking about, what does he really mean by that, so, I think it's like a cheaper understanding of what is there. If you learn this in uni, I think it's the most valuable thing you can learn because, yeah, you can learn techniques in uni, but if you don't learn how to read how to think, you will just know the technique for the rest of your life but you'll never be able to develop. If you don't have the technique but you have the thinking, you can learn everything. So, that's what I was talking about.

**Researcher:** Ok, what would you say are the main problems of humanity?

**Marco:** We say that we do but we don't really know how to deal with differences, ok? Talking about different cultures, we say that we accept different cultures but, in my view, most times we don't, because we tend to think that what we learn through all our life is the truth, but we don't consider the truth of other people. for example, a Chinese and a Japanese guy, he grow in a very different cultural basis from ours, so it's something I think we can't unite, and we sometimes try to unite to built a global culture, and this is something that we really need to think about. Can we understand different perspectives? Can we accept really different perspectives? I don't think that's happening now. And this is something I think is important. I think it's a problem. Another thing that I would say that it's a problem, I think that, I wouldn't say the problem of humanity but of some people, I think people need to find a meaning for life. And this would make a huge difference in the

world. Because some people just focus on work, some people focus on family or people they care about, and some people focus on outside things: god and different religions like the goods – good actions and stuff. But young people, they really don't have nothing, they don't have a meaning for life. And I think that if you don't have a meaning you will stop, you have nothing to do. And I think that's why the world is quite confusing right now. I don't see a generation that is coming to the big steps as we saw in the past, I don't see people that really think ??? and want to do their maximum, like I told you that I had this approach here with older guys. My lecturer for example, she wants to do the maximum all the time and some students want to, but this is something that we're losing I think ... the meaning. People I think is just living for pleasure, and they don't do anything.

**Researcher:** I have another big one: what do you think is the reason for poverty in the world?

**Marco:** Well, first thing I would say is that we have really bad leaders, really bad governments in the world, and I think this is ... being really practical, or pragmatic, this is a cause for poverty, cause if you have a leader that is more interested in using his political power to build wealth and something ... so if you have these like Africa for example, after European colonisation, they have seen a lot of dictators there. And they, it slows down even more the development. Because of course the European colonisation wasn't good but after that there still has a lot of dictators there, and it was a problem for example: Ghana, they were the best country after the freedom, let's say like that, and they lost because of a bad leader, the first president. So I think that bad leaders is a major cause for poverty, and the second thing I would say is that we are deluded with the idea that people with people are good. But I think we can't expect that people will help each other like just because they are good. I think we can't rely on that because I don't think that's true to be honest. I think people tend to go for their own interests and if we don't live in the world thinking this way, we will still have poverty. For example, I don't expect that Europe wants to help African people just because of colonisation like I'm feeling guilty or about what my ancestors they've done and I'm going to help you. I don't think that's going to happen, really. If you see for example the... David Cameron that's won here the general election. One of the things he said is a referendum for Europe position, so they really want to think about their position in the EU, because they want to think what is best for England. I don't think they're going to think what is best for the EU just and alone. And I see that in Brazil with the South America group, I really think that we need to change the perspective. Because if you want to develop every part of the world, you need to do like, hmm, Singapore, they are really a better nation now, because they thought ok, we will start our own development and we will invest in culture, we will invest in business, our people are going to be effective and we're going to open the market and we're going to fight with the foreign market. I'm not going to wait for someone to give me things and to be good. I'm going to grow up. So I think this is one reason. Because we can't try to find external reasons for our own failure. I think we have different backgrounds and we have different stories and things happened in the past that contribute for our situation but if we don't stand up and try to change our situation we are going to stay like that for ever. I see that in Brazil for example. We were a colonised nation and you know, Portugal sent the majority of people in the beginning for Brazil they didn't want to colonise Brazil they didn't have interest until they found gold. So hmm, they just sent here prisoners and bandits, so I can say that my nation was built by this kind of people. I don't want to judge them you know what I mean? If you think about building a nation with people who made bad things they aren't focused on developing and working you know? So I could say Brazil is like that because Portugal colonised Brazil. US is important because UK colonised the US and they sent good people there, they sent like the workers. I could say that, but we're talking about 500 years. So we had time to develop. But if you go to Brazil you'll find people saying it is Portugal's fault... And they are like, they

tend to be seated waiting something magical happen. I think we need to embrace our situation and even though bad things happened in the past, we need to know that people are bad, from their nature. It's human nature. And I don't really think we need to stay there waiting that people will change magically and become good and help us. I think we need to stand up and go for it, really build our own development. And this is going to change poverty if we can... I think the best action that we could expect from some people is to help people to understand that and I think people just understand that by reading. I think this is the key, so, ok I'm talking about people not being good, but you need to rely on that, that people need to get this information somehow. I don't see other solution. I don't think we can expect that wealthy nations will take care of poor nations because they won't. Let's suppose that they start doing that. For some reason they have a problem in their country. I think it's obvious that they will come back and focus on their country. I really don't expect people to be good.

**Researcher:** Do you think the concept of GC mean anything or can mean anything?

**Marco:** I've never heard this before, I'm just trying to figure out...

**Researcher:** Well some people call it world citizenship, citizens of the Earth...

**Marco:** I would say it is related with multiculturalism. I would say that GC would be a person that know about different cultures but not a person with a single culture, I don't think that's possible. I would go for this line...

## Interview 6 – Lena 4/7/15

(Researcher: Reminding Lena why he was interested in interviewing her...)

**Lena:** In Brazil we pay a lot of taxes and I didn't see the return for the people. I feel I'm very lucky because I've received these return of government. And because of this I think I have a compromised with the Brazil people. they are paying my education, I would like to return it in some way, I tried to study hard and learn more about the things that I couldn't learn in Brazil, for example, Brazil it's not good in industry, pharmaceutical industry. In the UK I could learn a lot of industry. Maybe some of my knowledge can help Brazil develop something good, I don't know...

**Researcher:** I'm going to ask you some questions about your course. How many were there on your course.

**Lena:** Around 40 people. Half of my class was Brazil. And the most of others: Indians and Muslim, I don't know, I'm not sure.

**Researcher:** Chinese people?

**Lena:** Only 2

**Researcher:** Did you have the chance to work with them, with people other than Brazilian?

**Lena:** I almost did all the work with Brazilian people because I live with one other girl, we do the homework together, the course work together, because it's more easy for us.

**Researcher:** But did you have group work? For example, where maybe the tutor would decide who you should work with...

**Lena:** No it's always been our choice. I don't remember working with people that are not Brazil.

**Researcher:** One of the things I'm interested in is how much, doing this course, you have learned in terms of intercultural communication, knowledge...

**Lena:** I think I didn't expand my perspective in this respect. I didn't do friendships with another people, I don't know, I was very close, I don't know, even with Brazilian people I didn't do many friendships...

**Researcher:** Are you a lonely person?

**Lena:** I didn't used to be but here I think I was more lonely.

**Researcher:** And do you feel that you could have got more from knowing people from here, from there...

**Lena:** Yes, I think I should make some efforts to know more people, but I kind of ... I was in my comfort zone I think...

**Researcher:** Interesting, and was there something in the course that could have pushed you out of this comfort zone?

**Lena:** Yes maybe if the professor would choose the group maybe I didn't do it with the Brazilian people.

**Researcher:** But you always had a choice who to work with?

**Lena:** Yes.

**Researcher:** Are there things on the course that relate to globalisation or to how your subject is impacted by it?

**Lena:** No because some modules are very related to UK regulations, so in this respect I didn't learn much about other places. I think in general what I studied can be applied to any country.

**Researcher:** My idea is that globalisation today is changing the way we live, how we work, how we see the world... how is globalisation impacting your profession?

**Lena:** For example, in industry, UK and USA for example developed technology, in Brazil and other developing countries they only import technology and reproduce. So I think in this aspect, hmm, globalisation affects the way we work...

**Researcher:** So maybe the aspect that is most impacted by globalisation is marketization, the business?

**Lena:** Yes I think. I don't know in the health area because I didn't study much about health care in NHS here, in SUS in Brazil [NHS the equivalent] because it is the focus of my course in Brazil but not in the UK. It's more on industry so I think globalisation affects more this market, I don't know...

**Researcher:** So would you say that in your course there are many, enough or not enough elements relating to how globalisation is changing this profession?

**Lena:** I think it's not obvious in my course. Because it's very, hmm, it's more like science, it's not like human social course. So I didn't think the teachers focused on these aspects. I try to remember but I couldn't...

**Researcher:** Can you tell me a bit about your background in Brazil. Would you consider your family middle-class, upper class?

**Lena:** My family I think is middle-class, but my family is a little bit different because my father is a surfer.

**Researcher:** Professional surfer?

**Lena:** No, hmm, he works with surf in general, he does the surf boards and this kind of things. And my parents live near the beach, easy life, it's ... I always studied in public schools in Brazil, and I went to a public uni, but in Brazil public uni are the best and private uni are not so good. And I always see myself doing pharmacy in the future, I can't see myself doing another thing. And I believe I maybe can change [laughs] the world with my profession in the future, don't know how yet but, I see good perspectives for health professionals to change the things, I don't know.

**Researcher:** And is your family from European descent?

**Lena:** Italian descent, hmm, but I think it's only my grand-grand fathers and mothers. My grand father and mother are Brazilian.

**Researcher:** What do you mean by Brazilian?

**Lena:** They were born in Brazil but they're parents were Italians, immigrants.

**Researcher:** Isn't Brazil very multi ethnic and multi cultural?

**Lena:** In Brazil in the South, they're more European descendants and in the North they're more African. So in the South the most of people are descendants of German and Italian, some Japanese.

**Researcher:** Where are you from? What city?

**Lena:** Florianopolis. Florianopolis is multicultural because most people in Brazil would like to live in Florianopolis, high quality of life. Many people of other places would like to live in Florianopolis. My father and my mother are from other cities in the South. And they came to Florianopolis 30 years ago and established there. They like to live there, and I like to live there. If I could I didn't go out Florianopolis. But Florianopolis didn't have a good employability for me, I would like to work in industry but Florianopolis didn't have industry.

**Researcher:** So you might have to move?

**Lena:** yes, to São Paulo, it's more famous...

**Researcher:** Or to another country?

**Lena:** Maybe. If I want I think I could but I'm not sure I'd like to live in Brazil. Despite all the problems we have, politics, violence, but in general I like to live in Brazil, I like the people, the weather... for example I think here in UK life is much more superior than Brazil but I didn't adapt myself very good here I think, I can't explain. But I'd like to live in Brazil, if I could I'd stay.

**Researcher:** So in Florianopolis are there different communities? like descendants from Arica, Europe and native Indians?

**Lena:** It's not so multicultural like here, it's more other Brazilian people living there. We didn't have people from other countries, from other states...

**Researcher:** How about descendants from natives, and slaves? So what does Florianopolis look like?

**Lena:** Florianopolis looks like more like Europe, we don't have much African descendants neither Indians.

**Researcher:** So they're more in the North?

**Lena:** Yes, South East is very similar to Europe. Cities like Santa Catarina is a mini Germany in Brazil. São Paulo is different, São Paulo is very multicultural. And in the North, it's more Indian descendants and Afro-descendants.

**Researcher:** Do you have friends who are black or Indian?

**Lena:** Indian I think [hesitation] not. Afro-descendants maybe some but in Florianopolis it is difficult to find black people I think. In the North I think 50% of population are black for example.

**Researcher:** I'd like to move to something different. So you've been here one year. Can you tell me of occasions where you have encountered cultural difficulty?

**Lena:** The major difficulty for me is listening, because some people here has a strong accent, I couldn't understand. In general, I understand the listening ok but the accent makes it more difficult. But in general I didn't find many difficulties. People here are very polite and hmm, would like to help. People are in general very kind and really try to help.

**Researcher:** Have you experienced culture shock?

**Lena:** I think one point is that in Brazil we are very receptive of the other people, and Brazilian people are much to touch and [??] in the UK people like their space. But I always knew it would be this way...

**Researcher:** So you have not experienced culture shock really...

**Lena:** Yyyyyyyes [meaning no I haven't], it's not a very culture shock I think.

**Researcher:** Maybe because the culture is not that different.

**Lena:** Yes maybe. Brazilian people are a little bit more prepared to live abroad because we have our Brazil way to do things, it's our expression in Brazil that Brazilian people always find the solution for little problems, it's Brazilian way to solve problems. I think we can adapt well to other environments I think, more than Chinese people for instance. I'm not sure, it's only observation.

**Researcher:** I'd like to talk about skills and the things that you were expecting to learn before you came?

**Lena:** Improve the English language is the obvious. hmm, for the more maybe, the thing of self study. In Brazil we aren't very independent in uni, we have a lot of classes, hours of classes, and a lot of tests, so we only study for tests, because we don't have time to go deep in some subjects we like for example or what we are interested in because we don't have time. Here we have less classes, less hours of classes, so we have more time to learn about what is our interest. It's the more important skill I learned here, to study by myself, go find things by myself, with no teachers saying what to do. It was good.

**Researcher:** So that's something you were aware of before you came. And also you mentioned learning English, you said it's obvious, but why is it so important?

**Lena:** Because it is the universal language. I think the major knowledge in the world are in English so if don't know what to understand English you have no access to this information like papers and articles. I think this is one thing I had difficulty in Brazil, I avoid to use articles in English because I didn't understand very well, I always needed to translate pages, hmm... Nowadays I get some articles, I can read and understand almost everything only reading, I didn't, I don't need to translate using some tool from the Internet let's say.



For my area it's very important because we always are need to read some articles in English, it's the research is all in English.

**Researcher:** So that's something you were expecting and you've achieved.

**Lena:** Yes, I think. The writing and the reading I think I could get the most I could, but the speaking I didn't practice much and I kind of regret...

**Researcher:** You've missed opportunities?

**Lena:** Yes.

**Researcher:** So what would you do if you had another year?

**Lena:** Maybe I would like to live with people other than Brazilian. Because the convivencia I think it was very good for me if I have this contact with people.

**Researcher:** What more could you learn if you had this opportunity?

**Lena:** First, respect the culture, know the culture, and practice my English too. Because sometimes this cultural thing, you are doing something that you could be offending the people and you don't know for example.

**Researcher:** Have you changed your view on your own country?

**Lena:** I think I could recognise the value of my country, I give more value to Brazil, in some respect.

**Researcher:** To Brazil or to being Brazilian?

**Lena:** To be Brazilian too I think. I don't know. I can't find a specific point...

**Researcher:** Does it have something to do with knowing who you are...

**Lena:** One thing I learned here is that I'll always be a Brazilian, I'll never be American or British. Some people in Brazil think when you go to live abroad you can become British for example. Here we learn that dependant of the country where we are living we'll always be Brazilian, you can't change your origin. Your way to be...

**Researcher:** So do you feel more Brazilian?

**Lena:** Yes. But with another point of you, more wide I think. I can't explain this feeling. I have a feeling of not belonging to any country anymore. Cause I'm Brazilian but now I lived here I feel a little bit British maybe. I never belong to one or other country. Before I'm Brazil I think I belong to Brazil. Or now I belong to UK, now it's all mixed up this feeling of belonging. It's strange, because of this I think it will be difficult to readapt to Brazil.

**Researcher:** Some people say that the more you feel you're a citizen of the world the more you 're aware of your roots, so maybe you're more Brazilian but at the same time you're more "of the world", ...

**Lena:** It's exactly what I feel now, after one year... It's a very strange feeling.

**Researcher:** To go back to what we started with, we started speaking about the sort of responsibility that you have towards Brazil people... DO you think there is a kind of responsibility towards people from anywhere?

**Lena:** [All the Brazilian students at DMU are from the "Science Without Borders" programme ] I think the objective of this programme are change the mind of young people in Brazil, but on the other hand when people know Europe and how things work well here, some people didn't want to come back. They want to find a job here, or continue to study here, and it's not the objective of the programme, the objective is people change their minds and come back to Brazil with new ideas to change the country and change some traditional ideas that avoid the progress, the development. I hope that young people are doing the "Science Without Borders" programme will come back to Brazil with a desire to change things in Brazil, not to leave it behind. I think it was positive because people come back with the desire to return the investment. Because we learn a lot and we could see other cultures and it was very grateful, I don't know...

**Researcher:** The idea behind global citizenship, for some people, is that we are all one human race, and that borders maybe are not relevant.... global citizenship is about feeling the link we have with everyone, how do you feel about that?

**Lena:** For me, now that I've lived abroad, I can feel this, but I think for some people they don't feel it yet, because I think in general people would like to feel that they belong to a group but sometimes it's bad it can lead to trouble, war for example; because you don't see other people like your brother of human being, I don't know, and sometimes it's difficult for people to see what we already said. We all belong to the same place, we all belong to Earth, to humanity.

**Researcher:** And what does define these groups, these communities, is it just borders?

**Lena:** Difficult to answer this.... Because it could be religion, it could be the place, the costumes, the culture, I don't know... Because we have so many groups, because I belong to a country but I belong to my university, to my neighbourhood ... and now I belong here in a certain way too.

**Researcher:** What do you think, hmm, a global citizen should be or should be able to do or what do you think people would have to learn to become global citizenship?

**Lena:** I think tolerance is the first; respect...

**Researcher:** What do you mean by tolerance and respect?

**Lena:** Tolerance is ... you ... even you don't agree with people, their opinions, you must respect and try to understand the different points of view, and never act with violence for example because of this difference. Because it is the origin of the wars for example, the intolerance. It can be religious, ethnic, so I think tolerance and respect is the most important things for our global citizenship.

**Researcher:** Do you think if people felt like global citizenship it would make life better or would it solve some problems that we have?

**Lena:** Oh of course! I think for example the problem with Islamic state, you know, intolerance, religious intolerance, many people die because they don't agree with the same god, it's kind of absurd for me, and I think all people have this global way of thinking, this thing of belonging to the world not to religion or a country, things would be better. [blank] I don't know, I though things would become more, in this respect of the convivencia between people from different countries but with this thing of Islamic state, it scares me a little bit, this kind of intolerance, it's much violence for nothing, and I think it's such a pity it's going this way.